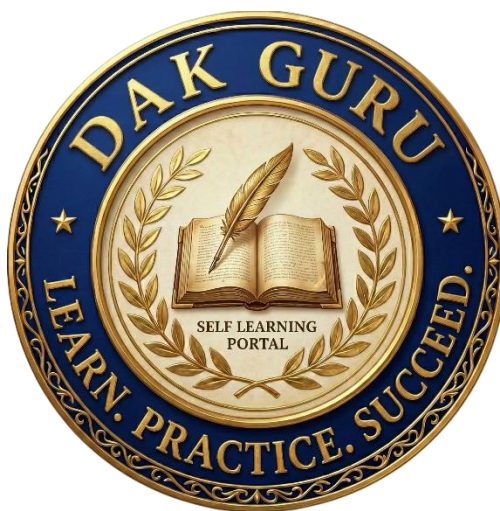


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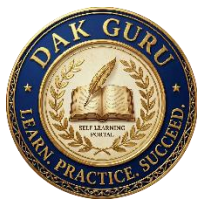
POSTAL MANUAL VOLUME VIII

Inspection & Administrative Standards

Comprehensive Study Booklet for
LDCE Inspector of Posts (IP) • PS Group 'B' Examination

Edition 2026 — Complete rule-by-rule coverage, verified against primary statutory sources

Obsolete or disused rules are flagged with reasons, not silently dropped



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DISCLAIMER & STUDY GUIDANCE

Purpose of this booklet

This booklet has been prepared **strictly from an examination point of view** to assist candidates preparing for the LDCE Inspector of Posts and Postal Services Group 'B' Examinations. It distils the duties, inspection standards and administrative responsibilities laid down in *Postal Manual Volume VIII* into a structured, readable form with explanatory notes, memory aids and current-position flags.

Accuracy, currency & verification

Every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and to incorporate recent changes, amendments and updates to the relevant Acts, Rules, Regulations and departmental orders. Statutory content has been **cross-checked against primary sources** — the Postal Manual Volume VIII, Department of Posts and DoPT instructions, gazette notifications and SB Orders — in force as at the date of this edition.

Where the latest position could not be conclusively confirmed, or where a provision is in transition (for example, items affected by the **Post Office Act, 2023 / Post Office Rules, 2024** and the IT 2.0 rollout), this has been flagged explicitly through a **"Currency note"** box rather than papered over with assumptions.

Important — please read

This document is a **study aid only** and does not carry official or legal authority. Rules, periodicities, monetary limits and forms are revised by the Department from time to time. Readers and candidates are **strongly advised** to refer to the latest official government sources, gazette notifications and departmental circulars for the most

reliable and authoritative position, especially before relying on any provision for official action.

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How to use the colour-coded boxes in this booklet

- **In simple terms** — plain-language explanation of a rule.
- **Memory aid** — tricks, mnemonics and number-anchors for quick recall.
- **Currency note** — the latest verified position and any recent change.
- **Exam focus** — points and figures most frequently tested in the IP / PS Gr.B papers.

A note on completeness

This edition aims to cover **every rule** of the volume, chapter by chapter. Some rules are formally marked “*Omitted*” or “*Deleted*” in the manual itself; others, though still printed, relate to instruments or services that have ceased in current practice (for example, British/Irish Postal Orders, the telegraph branch of combined offices, or radio-licence registers). Such rules are **not explained in detail**; instead each is listed — with the reason — in a **Skip-Log** at the end of the relevant chapter, so that nothing is silently dropped and you can see exactly what was set aside and why.

Introduction — How to Read Volume VIII

Postal Manual Volume VIII is the Department of Posts' rule-book on **inspection, supervision and administrative control**. Where Volumes II–VI tell you *how* the post office processes mail, savings, insurance and accounts, Volume VIII tells you *who* must inspect *what*, *how often*, and *in which form*. The volume is organised into ten chapters by the office of the supervising functionary:

Chapter	Subject	Status in this edition
1	Heads of Circles (Rules 1–89)	Covered in full
2	Superintendents (Rules ~112–239)	Covered in full
3	Inspectors of Post Offices (Rules ~260–300)	Covered in full
4	Town Inspectors & Overseer-Postmen	Covered in full
5	Asst. Superintendents & Inspectors, RMS	Covered in full
6	Omitted (no content in the manual)	Nil — noted
7	Overseers	Covered in full
8	Stock Depots (Rules ~357–390)	Covered in full
9	Returned Letter Offices (Rules ~389–434)	Covered in full
10	Breaks and Accidents	Covered in full

In simple terms

Think of the volume as a **ladder of supervision**. At the top sits the DG and the Head of the Circle (CPMG); below them the Postmasters General / Directors of Postal Services; then the Superintendents (SP/SSP, Posts and RMS); then the Inspectors (IPO) and Assistant Superintendents (ASP); and on the ground the Overseers and Branch offices. Each rung inspects the rung below it, on a fixed timetable, using fixed forms. Chapters 1–4 — the Head of the Circle, the Superintendent, the Inspector and the Town Inspector — carry much of the examination weight.

Exam focus

Four anchors unlock most Volume VIII questions: (1) **WHO** is the responsible officer; (2) **HOW OFTEN** — the periodicity; (3) the **FORM** number; and (4) the **DEADLINE / TIME-LIMIT**. Read every rule hunting for these four.

Chapter	Subject	Status in this edition
Currency note (latest position) Volume VIII has not been re-issued as a fresh consolidated volume, so the rules remain the examination framework. Three modern developments form the backdrop and are flagged at the relevant rules: (i) the Post Office Act, 2023 (in force 18 June 2024) and the Post Office Rules, 2024, which replaced the Indian Post Office Act, 1898 and the IPO Rules, 1933; (ii) the end of the telegraph service (15 July 2013) and the 1985 Posts–Telecom split, which render the “combined office / telegraph” rules obsolete; and (iii) IT 2.0 / Core Banking (CSI), which has moved savings-bank, pension and statistical work onto electronic systems. Confirm monetary limits and forms against the current order before any official use.		



Chapter 1 — Heads of Circles

Chapter 1 is the largest and most heavily examined chapter of Volume VIII. It defines the **Head of the Circle** (the Chief Postmaster General) and lists, rule by rule, the personal duties and the miscellaneous powers exercised at the apex of the Circle. The chapter runs from Rule 1 to Rule 89. Of these, several rules are formally “Omitted” or “Deleted” in the manual itself, and a few more, though still printed, relate to instruments or arrangements that have since ceased in practice. To keep the notes accurate and uncluttered, such rules are **not explained in detail**; instead each is listed — with the reason — in the **Skip-Log** at the end of the chapter, so that nothing is silently dropped.

In simple terms

The chapter divides naturally into two blocks. **Rules 1–11 = Personal Duties** — things the Head of the Circle must do himself (inspect, examine diaries, watch pension work). **Rules 12–89 = Miscellaneous Rules** — a long list of specific powers and procedures (registers, complaints, postal orders, savings-bank sanctions, statistics, mail arrangements).

Exam focus

From Chapter 1 the perennial favourites are: the **Stock Depot inspection split (R2)**, the **once-a-year self-inspection (R2-A)**, **RLO inspection (R8)**, **GPO balance verification 4×/year (R10)**, the **Complaints categories A/B/C/D and form CPT-3 (R14)**, **record-preservation periods (R16)**, **inspection periodicities (R20–21)**, **monthly statistics Ms-14(c) by the 20th (R28)**, and the **Feb/Aug enumeration (R31)**.

Block A — Personal Duties (Rules 1–11)

Rule 1 — Who is the “Head of a Circle”

The **Head of a Circle** is the chief officer of a Postal Circle and includes the **Postmaster General** and Directors in independent charge of a Circle. All Senior Superintendents, Superintendents, Inspectors, Postmasters and other officers in the Circle are **subordinate** to the Head of the Circle. The Head of the Circle’s administrative powers are defined in *Postal Manual Volume III*, and the financial powers in the *Schedule of Financial Powers*.

- **Note 1:** “Superintendent” wherever used includes “Senior Superintendent”.

- **Note 3:** For the Army Postal Service, the Director, Army Postal Services exercises all the powers of a Head of Circle.

Currency note (latest position)

Note 2 of the printed rule refers to “Telephone districts and Posts & Telegraphs workshops” where General Managers were Heads of Circles. This reflects the pre-1985 **combined Posts & Telegraphs** set-up. Since the 1985 split into the Department of Posts and the Department of Telecommunications, the telegraph/telephone limb no longer applies to the postal cadre — read this rule as relating to Postal Circles only.

Rule 2 — Inspection of the Stock Depot

The **Head of the Circle or the Director Postal Services** carries out the **first inspection** of the Stock Depot in the half-year ending **30th September**, together with the **physical verification** of all articles of stores and stock. The **second inspection** for the half-year ending **31st March** is carried out by the **Assistant Postmaster-General / Assistant Director** in charge of the Stock Depot, who checks that the first inspection’s orders were complied with and discrepancies reconciled.

- **Central Forms Stores note:** For the three Central Forms Stores — Postal Stores Depot Aligarh, PSD Kolkata and PSD Nasik Road — the physical verification of forms is done during the second (March) inspection each year.

Memory aid

“**First-half = top officer + count; Second-half = APMG + check**”. First inspection ends 30 Sep (with physical verification); second ends 31 Mar (compliance check).

Rule 2-A — Inspection of the Circle Office (self-inspection)

The Head of the Circle inspects **his own office once a year** and submits the Inspection Report to the **Director General, Posts**. A further complete report on action taken is sent to the Directorate **after six months**. The office of the Director of Postal Life Insurance is inspected once a year by the Senior DDG / DDG (Postal Services), besides the Director’s own inspection.

Rule 3 — Visits to Offices, Sections and Mail Lines

The Head of the Circle should visit head offices, principal mail lines and sorting offices **as often as convenient**. A Postmaster General should, if possible, visit **every district**

headquarters station at least once in two years. At each visit to a Presidency or first-class head office the Postmaster's administrative work is examined against the standard inspection questions; important sub-offices and small offices should be visited as opportunity arises to test rural delivery.

Rule 4 — Disposal of Copies of Order-Book Remarks

The Head of the Circle should **personally dispose of** all copies of order-book remarks submitted in respect of inspections and verifications of accounts, and should from time to time call for and examine the inspection/verification notes held in Superintendents' offices.

Rule 5 — Examination of Superintendents' Diaries

The Head of the Circle must **personally examine** the diaries of Superintendents (Form **Genl-1**) to check idleness and unduly long halts, and in the RMS to ensure enough time is spent in mail vans and mail offices. He must see that inspections and verifications do not fall into arrears. In major Circles, the Director of Postal Services may be permitted to scrutinise the weekly diaries.

Rule 6 — Examination of Punishment Registers

The Head of the Circle examines the copies of punishment registers (Form **APP-32(a)**) submitted by subordinate offices, to keep watch on punishments awarded and to ensure officials are not kept under suspension unnecessarily.

Memory aid

Punishment register = **APP-32(a)**; Superintendent's diary = **Genl-1**. Two of the most-asked form numbers in the chapter.

Rule 7 — Control over Pension Work

The Head of the Circle must keep **constant watch on pension work**, personally scrutinising the monthly consolidated return of pending pension and gratuity cases (compiled from returns in Form **Est-52**) and accelerating any case pending **three months or more**. No pension or gratuity case for subordinates appointed by him should leave the office without his signature.

Currency note (latest position)

The supervisory duty remains valid, but the **mechanics are now electronic**. Pension processing for Central Government employees is through **e-HRMS / Bhavishya** and the Pension Sanctioning workflow; for staff under the National Pension System (NPS), exit/withdrawal is processed via the PFRDA/CRA system. The “three-month” vigilance benchmark and the principle of the Head of Circle’s oversight still hold — only Form Est-52 as a manual return has largely given way to system dashboards.

Rule 8 — Inspection of Returned Letter Offices (RLO)

The Head of the Circle or Director Postal Services must inspect the **RLO once every year** (period ending 30th September), per the standard questions. The APMG / ADPS additionally inspects for the period ending 31st March. Both should pay frequent visits to satisfy themselves that work is properly conducted.

In simple terms

The RLO (Returned Letter Office, historically the “Dead Letter Office”) is set up at the Circle headquarters and handles unclaimed, refused and undeliverable articles, and those with undecipherable or incomplete addresses. Because it holds value and confidential matter, it is inspected annually by a senior officer.

Rule 9 — Enquiries with Local Officers

When visiting a divisional headquarters, the Head of the Circle (or any Director) should meet the **Commissioner / District officers** to learn whether the public is getting satisfactory service. Postmasters, Superintendents (Posts and RMS) and Divisional Engineers should keep in close touch with Collectors and local officers.

Rule 10 — Verification of GPO / Presidency Balances

The balances of the **Mumbai, Kolkata and Chennai GPOs and the Delhi HO** must be verified **four times a year** — one by the Director Postal Services and three by the **City Superintendent of Post Offices**. An officer lower in status than the Postmaster confines himself to standard questions Nos. 1–21 of Part A of the Head Office verification report.

Currency note (latest position)

Verified position: **FOUR times a year (1 DPS + 3 City SP)**. A common error states “two times” — that figure belongs to the Presidency Postmaster’s twice-yearly verification of GPO branches under Rule 21, not to this rule. City names now read Mumbai / Kolkata / Chennai (formerly Bombay / Calcutta / Madras).

Rule 11 — Responsibility for Postal Arrangements at Headquarters

The Head of the Circle is **personally responsible** for proper postal arrangements for the public at his headquarters and must be thoroughly acquainted with the method and arrangement of work at the headquarters office(s).



Block B — Miscellaneous Rules (Rules 12–89)

Rule 12 — Assistant Postmasters-General (APMG)

APMGs are officers attached to the Head of the Circle's office to assist personally in **inspection, investigation and supervision**. They should be freely deputed away from headquarters — especially in serious cases of robbery, abstraction or fraud — and not allowed to degenerate into mere office assistants. Inspectors are also attached for similar duties.

- **Note:** “Assistant Postmaster-General” here includes a Personal Assistant and an Assistant Director of Postal Services, unless the context shows otherwise.

Rule 13 — Registers and Records in a Circle Office

A long list of registers must be maintained in the Head of the Circle's office and kept up to date. The most frequently examined of these (and the ones worth memorising) are:

Register	Form / Note
Register of complaints	Form Capt-1 (some prints: CPT-1)
Register of highway robberies	—
Register of absconders in Post Office cases	—
Register of lines and stages	Form M-40
Register of losses and frauds	see Rule 15
Register of registered newspapers	see Rule 30
Register of weighment-system despatches	Form M-162
Register of budget allotments (fluctuating contingent charges)	Form Bgt-14

- **Residual power:** Where no form is laid down, the Head of each Circle prescribes the form to be used. The full printed list contains 38 entries, several of them now historic (e.g. Broadcast Receiver Licence registers) — see the Skip-Log.

Rule 14 — Register of Complaints (high-yield)

The register of complaints is maintained in manuscript (proforma **CPT-1**). Each complaint is classified into one of four categories:

Category	Meaning
A	Due to service fault.
B	Due to reasons beyond the control of the Department.
C	Due to human delinquency (service falling below prescribed norms).
D	Groundless.

- **Separate registers:** Maintained separately for postal, telegraph and telephone enquiries (the latter two now historic for the Department of Posts).
- **Monthly review:** A monthly abstract and summary, plus the statement of complaints (Form CPT-3) from subordinate units, are placed before the Head of the Circle, who takes serious notice of cases pending over six months.
- **Quarterly return (Rule 14-A):** A statement of receipt, disposal and pendency of complaints for each quarter must reach the Directorate by the 20th of the following month (e.g. the quarter ending 31st March → by 20th April).
- **Inspection of complaint branches (Rule 14-B):** Complaint branches of divisional/gazetted-postmaster offices are inspected once a year against the prescribed questionnaire.

Exam focus

Lock the four categories — **A = service fault, B = beyond control, C = human delinquency, D = groundless** — and the form: complaint statement = **CPT-3**. This is one of the single most-asked items from Chapter 1.

Rule 15 — Register of Loss / Fraud / Misappropriation

A Circle-level register records loss/fraud/misappropriation cases continuously, in **seven sections**:

Section	Type of case
1	Registered articles (incl. uninsured V.P. articles)
2	Insured articles (incl. insured V.P. articles)
3	Money Orders (incl. Telegraphic & V.P. money orders)
4	Savings Bank accounts (incl. D.S.B. accounts)
5	Post Office Certificates

Section	Type of case
6	Misappropriation of cash or stamps
7	Miscellaneous (thefts of articles, etc.)

- **Compilation:** Built from monthly extracts of a similar register received from the Divisional Superintendents. Primary offenders are marked 'P' and subsidiary offenders 'S'.

Memory aid

Loss/Fraud register = **7 sections**; Complaints = **4 categories (A–D)**. Don't mix the two counts up.

Rule 16 — Disposal of Records (Preservation Periods)

This rule prescribes how long each class of record is preserved. The printed list is very long (80+ entries, many of them Postal Life Insurance ledgers); the **exam-relevant** preservation periods are:

Class of Record	Preservation Period
Appeals	3 years after the month the case is closed
DG's Circulars & General Orders	3 years after the close of the year of issue
Diaries of Superintendents	1 year after the month to which they relate
Inspection reports & order-book verification remarks	1 year after the year received
Annual Report of the Head of the Circle	1 year after the year received
Annual Report of a Superintendent	3 years after the year received
Rulings on all subjects	Permanent
Establishment cases (creation/revision/abolition in foreign territory)	Permanent
Other establishment cases	20 years
Contracts & leases (treasure, stamp-vending, mails, etc.)	12 years after termination
Service Books / Service Rolls (not retired on pension)	5 years after severance

Class of Record	Preservation Period
Invalid / extraordinary pension cases	25 years from sanction
Other pension cases	5 years after retirement
Tour programmes	6 months after completion of the tour
Exam focus Number anchors: Superintendent's diary = 1 yr; DG circulars = 3 yrs; tour programme = 6 months; invalid pension = 25 yrs; rulings = permanent.	

Rule 17 — Jurisdiction & Headquarters of Superintendents

The Head of the Circle **fixes the extent and headquarters of each Superintendent's division**. The headquarters is ordinarily at the most central station and always at one having a head post office. Redistribution of jurisdictions — and any change in the **name of a division** — must be notified to the Director General and the Audit Office.

Memory aid

Who fixes a Superintendent's jurisdiction / changes a division's name? **The Head of the Circle** (a classic single-fact MCQ).

Rule 18 — Jurisdiction & Headquarters of Inspectors

The Head of the Circle **fixes the extent and headquarters of each Inspector's sub-division**.

Rule 19 — Accommodation for Superintendents' Offices

If there is insufficient accommodation in the circle office or post office, the Superintendent's office is located in another suitable Government building if available, or else in a rented building.

Rule 20 — Inspection of the Superintendent's Office

The office of every Superintendent of Post Offices and RMS is thoroughly inspected at least **once in every 12 months**. The Head of the Circle takes up such inspections as he desires; the rest may be delegated to Directors of Postal Services.

Rule 21 — Inspection of Offices and Sections (key periodicities)

This rule fixes how often each class of office and section is inspected and its balances verified. The figures are heavily examined:

Office / Section	Inspection / Verification frequency
First-class Head Office (except Presidency)	Inspected once in 12 months by the SSPO; administrative branch also inspected once a year
Second-class Head Office	Inspected twice in 12 months (≈6-month intervals) by the Superintendent
HO balances	Verified twice by the Superintendent + four times by the Inspector in 12 months
All sub & branch offices	Inspected twice in 12 months , divided between Superintendent and Inspectors (branch-office systematic inspection is the Inspector's special duty)
Every mail office / record office / section	Inspected twice in 12 months , divided between Superintendent, ASP and Sub-divisional Inspector (RMS)
Presidency GPO branches	Inspected by the Presidency Postmaster twice a year

Exam focus

The trap: **1st-class HO = once a year**, but **2nd-class HO, sub/branch offices and mail offices = twice a year**. HO balances are checked **2 (SP) + 4 (IPO) = effectively very frequently**. Note this Rule 21 frequency is the statutory backbone; the day-count durations (6 days for HO, etc.) come from the inspection schedule under Rule 238 in Chapter 2.

Rule 22 — Director-General's Circulars

DG circulars are issued per distribution lists furnished by Heads of Circles. Postal notices are issued separately (not as annexures); ordinarily only **two copies** of each notice go to an office (one for the noticeboard, one for record). Printing-press type for a postal notice is kept standing for **ten days** for additional copies.

Rule 23 — Circulars of Heads of Circles

A Head of Circle's orders for general guidance are published as a **monthly circular** with a consecutive annual series of numbers. Circulars need not go to branch offices, but matters concerning them are put into **Branch Office Circulars** in the local language. Copies of all circulars go to the DG's office. Circulars are **destroyed after 3 years** (counting from the April following the close of the year of issue); tour movements are issued as "Tour Orders", not circulars.

Memory aid

DG circular = **weekly** (Chapter 3, R295); Head-of-Circle circular = **monthly**; both destroyed after **3 years**.

Rule 25 — Applications for Interception of Articles

Applications to intercept articles passing through a sorting office/section are **refused except in very special cases**, and never granted if the office of posting is not named or if the article is expected by more than one mail. Disposal rests with the Head of the Circle.

Rule 26 — Return to Sender of Articles Posted (Recall)

Recall rules are in the Post Office Guide and Foreign Post Manual / PM Volume V. A recall application received directly is forwarded to the postmaster concerned with the Head of the Circle's order, the recall fee being converted into postage stamps affixed to the application.

Rule 27 — Applications for Information from Post Office Records

Information from post-office records is **ordinarily not given**; a Government officer is told it can be given only on the application of a **Secretary to the Government / Administration** concerned. Savings-bank, money-order and certificate books are produced in court only for special cause.

Currency note (latest position)

This long-standing confidentiality rule now sits alongside the **Right to Information Act, 2005** and the **Post Office Act, 2023**. Disclosure of postal records is today governed by those statutes and the Department's data-protection and interception safeguards; treat Rule 27 as the historic baseline, not the operative legal test for an RTI request.

Rule 28 — Monthly Statistics to the Director General

The Head of the Circle submits a monthly statement (Form **Ms-14(c)**) of ordinary, registered, insured and value-payable articles (letter and parcel mail), separating (a) Posts service articles and (b) other articles. It is compiled from Form **Ms-14(a)** from head offices, and must reach the DG by the **20th of the following month**. Separate statements are submitted for Kolkata, Mumbai and Chennai.

Rule 30 — Registered Newspapers

Newspaper registration in the Circle office follows the Post & Telegraph Guide. Registered newspapers posting **not less than 500 articles** at a time may post without affixing stamps, under a **licence (Form MS-97)** issued after applying in Form MS-96 and depositing security equal to one month's postage. The list of registered newspapers is corrected up to 1st January each year.

Currency note (latest position)

The printed rule cites **Section 9 of the Indian Post Office Act, 1898 and Rule 30 of the IPO Rules, 1933**. Both have been **repealed** and replaced by the **Post Office Act, 2023** and the **Post Office Rules, 2024** (in force 18 June 2024). The newspaper-registration scheme as a statutory category has been discontinued under the new Act; read the procedural detail as historic. The "500 articles" cash-payment threshold survives in practice for bulk posting (see Rule 75).

Rule 31 — Half-Yearly Enumeration Report

During the **second week of February and August** each year, a daily enumeration is made of ordinary unregistered articles and parcels given out for delivery. Supervising officers personally count and sign the enumeration returns at Circle/Division/Sub-division headquarters offices (Form MS-6). The Head of the Circle then reports the result to the DG using Form Pa-19. Reports are due **not later than 1st April (February enumeration) and 1st October (August enumeration)**.

Memory aid

Enumeration months **Feb & Aug** (2nd week); returns on **MS-6**; report on **Pa-19**; due 1 Apr / 1 Oct.

Rules 32–35 — Field (War) Postal Service

These rules cover the **Army Postal Service field arrangements**: the half-yearly list of volunteers for field service (supplementary list to the DG by **15th April and 15th October**; Rule 32), mobilisation of postal officials within **12 hours** of a DG telegram (Rule 33), the estimate of expenditure on field postal arrangements (Rule 34), and the report on field postal arrangements with a sketch map (Rule 35).

Currency note (latest position)

These remain on the books and are operationally relevant only to the **Army Postal Service (APS)** during mobilisation. For the civil IP / PS Gr.B syllabus they are low-yield; the figures worth carrying are the **15 Apr / 15 Oct** volunteer-list dates and the **12-hour** relief window.

Rule 36 — Memo of Authorised Balances & Advances (Presidency POs)

The Head of the Circle supplies each Presidency Post Office with a memo (Form **Pa-14**) showing the authorised minimum/maximum cash balances (fixed per Rules 138–139) and the maximum stamp balance. The maximum stamp balance equals **one week's demand plus the demand for the period between two supplies**. "Stamps" here includes postage stamps, postal stationery and non-postal stamps.

Rule 37 — Countersignature of Travelling Allowance (TA) Bills

On countersigning a TA bill (Form **TR-20 / TR-25**), any retrenchment must be explained to the officer and the bill returned to the preparer. TA bills must be disposed of promptly. The sanction for any journey outside an officer's jurisdiction is attached to the bill.

Rule 38 — Limit of Weight of Mails

Ordinary weight limits for letter and parcel mails are in Rule 135 of PM Volume V; the Head of the Circle may prescribe **lower limits** in the special circumstances mentioned there.

Rule 39 — Due Mail and Sorting Lists

Due mail and sorting lists (Form **M-9**) for offices/sections communicating across more than one RMS division are prepared by the Head of the Circle per Rule 136 of PM Volume V. Key thresholds in the rule: direct parcel communication is ordinarily not prescribed when the daily average is **fewer than 4 articles**; a direct parcel bag is ordered when the daily average exceeds **5 registered parcels**; and a direct mail bag may be closed when unregistered articles to an office/section in advance exceed **200 per day**.

Rule 40 — Objection Statements

The Head of the Circle assists the Audit Office in prompt adjustment of outstandings. In all cases of loss through **fraud, robbery or accident**, he passes early orders so the amount is

adjusted without delay — settled within **three months** by recovery from those at fault or by requesting the DG to write off the amount.

Rule 42 — Detention of Outward Mail Steamers

The Postmaster-General, Mumbai, may detain an outward mail steamer for **up to 24 hours** when certain outward foreign mails fail to arrive in time. A special train is not ordinarily used; the telegraph is used freely in cases of railway interruption.

Currency note (latest position)

This rule reflects the era of **sea-borne foreign mail by P&O steamer**. International mail is now carried predominantly by **air**, so steamer-detention is effectively obsolete in practice; retained as historic. Of marginal exam interest only for the “24 hours” figure.

Rule 44 — Report of Changes in Postal Routes & Communications

The Head of the Circle keeps the State Government / Administration informed of material changes in postal routes — changes in contract-steamer timings, alterations in main mail routes, and acceleration/retardation of mail services on important lines.

Rule 45 & 45-A — Interruptions of Mails; Requisition of Class-IV Staff by RMS

- **Rule 45:** On a report of a break, accident or misconnection likely to delay mails, the Head of the Circle may advise postmasters at important stations and order a local public notice — ordinarily whenever the foreign mail of an important station is affected.
- **Rule 45-A:** The Head of the Circle may prescribe post offices from which an RMS Head Sorter / Mail Guard may requisition a Class-IV official to escort mail or work as van peon if the section's van peon falls sick or misses the train.

Rule 46 — Functions of Post Offices

The Head of the Circle may restrict the classes of business performed by any office, and may suspend acceptance/despatch of postal articles (informing the DG). He may authorise a branch office to accept articles for insurance up to **₹600**, accept foreign parcels, receive inland telegrams, or perform savings-bank work. Divisional Superintendents may also authorise branch offices to perform savings-bank work. A month's notice is given to depositors before SB powers are withdrawn from an office.

Currency note (latest position)

The ₹600 branch-office insurance ceiling is a legacy figure; current insured-article value limits and branch-office authorisations are governed by the latest PO Guide / SB Order / Directorate instructions and are substantially higher. The **“receive inland telegrams” power is obsolete** following the end of the telegraph service (15 July 2013).

Rule 47 — Changes in Status of Offices & Transfer between Head Offices

Proposals to convert an HO↔SO, or transfer an SO/BO from one HO to another, are sanctioned (by the DG or the Head of the Circle) in time to take effect from the **beginning of a quarter**, with at least **one month’s notice** to the Audit Office. Conversions of SO↔BO and grant/withdrawal of SB powers to a branch office may be done at any time without prior notice to Audit.

Rule 48 — Exchange of Cash Remittances

The Head of the Circle prescribes how first-class head offices without a treasury are supplied with, and relieved of, funds. Cash sent through the post is enclosed in **cloth or leather cash bags** — leather when the remittance includes coin or exceeds **₹100**; cloth when notes only and not exceeding ₹100. Cash above **₹250** given to a special carrier should ordinarily be enclosed in a cash bag. Systematic remittance by bank-bills (hundi) or outside agency needs the DG’s sanction.

Rule 49 & 49-A — Cash Limits for Postmen; MO Verification Percentages

- **Rule 49:** The Head of the Circle may raise the aggregate cash entrusted to a single postman to ₹2,000, and to a single village postman to ₹500 (if the beat is police-certified reasonably safe); where raised to ₹500 the village postman may also take out money orders up to ₹100 each. The limit is shown in Form PA-4 and consolidated memo PA-15.
- **Rule 49-A:** An Inspector of Posts must verify payment of at least 25 money orders a month; Town Inspectors, Overseers and Overseer-Postmen at least 50 each. The Head of the Circle may fix a higher percentage by unit if money-order traffic warrants.

Memory aid

Cash with a single **postman ₹2,000, village postman ₹500** (+MO up to ₹100). MO verification: **IPO 25, others 50** per month.

Rule 50 — Payment of Money Orders by Pay Order

The Postmaster-General may authorise HOs and SOs in charge of LSG sub-postmasters or above to **pay money orders by pay order** where there is demand; copies of sanction letters go to the Audit Office.

Rule 51 — Sale of Indian Postal Orders

A Superintendent fixes the aggregate value of Indian Postal Orders for Head Offices; a Head Postmaster may authorise a sub-office to keep a stock of IPOs (copy to the office and the Superintendent).

Rule 53 — Refund of the Value of Indian Postal Orders

Heads of Circles may sanction payment/refund of defective IPOs that are beyond the powers of a Superintendent, First-Class Postmaster or Presidency Postmaster.

Rule 54-1 — Loss / Miscarriage of Indian Postal Orders

Applications about miscarriage, loss or destruction of IPOs (with counterfoils) go to the Deputy Accountant-General (Posts), Delhi, to check whether paid. A **certificate of non-payment** can be obtained only after **sixteen (16) months** from the last day of the month of issue; the Superintendent or First-Class Postmaster may then sanction a genuine refund.

Rule 55-1 & 55-2 — Loss / Theft of Unsold Indian Postal Orders

- **Rule 55-1:** The Head of the Circle may sanction refund to officials of amounts recovered for lost IPOs, but only after one full year has elapsed since the loss and non-payment is confirmed by the DAG (Posts), Delhi.
- **Rule 55-2:** On loss/theft of an IPO from stock (with a non-payment certificate), the Head of the Circle notifies the loss in his Circular; the Delhi Audit Office alerts all Circles with the index-letter and serial number so payment can be stopped.

Rule 56-1 / 56-2 / 56-3 — Orders & Certificates Lost After Payment / Before Issue

The Head of the Circle may authorise issue of a **certificate of payment** for an Indian Postal Order lost after payment (56-1) and for a Post Office Certificate lost after payment (56-2), after enquiry and notification in his Circular; loss/theft/destruction of certificates before issue or before delivery (56-3) is likewise notified to all Circles to prevent encashment.

Rules 57–66 — Savings Bank & Postal Certificate Sanctions

This block gives the Head of the Circle a set of **sanctioning and adjudicating powers** over savings-bank accounts and postal certificates in special situations:

- Accounts opened on behalf of minors and withdrawals from them (Rules 57–58) — guardianship recognised on Form SB-15, withdrawals governed by Rule 41 of the Rules for Depositors.
- Issue of a duplicate pass-book — fee may be waived where balance is under ₹100 and loss was beyond the depositor's control (Rule 59).
- Opening / closing of public accounts and excess withdrawals from public and regimental accounts beyond ₹1,000 in a month (Rules 60–62).
- Payment of a deceased / incapacitated depositor's balance — the Head of the Circle decides claims up to ₹5,000 cash or ₹5,000 nominal securities; above that, probate / letters of administration / succession certificate is required (Rule 63).
- Withdrawals by depositors who have left India; postal certificates held by lunatics or by minors, and payment of certificates of deceased holders (Rules 64–66).

Currency note (latest position)

These powers remain conceptually valid but the operative figures and procedure are now set by the **POSB (CBS) Manual and current SB Orders / Government Savings Promotion Act, 2018 and Rules, 2018**, under Core Banking. Monetary thresholds (e.g. the ₹5,000 deceased-claim limit) have been **revised upward** and deceased-claim settlement is now governed by the latest SB Order; the references here to the old “Rules for Depositors” are historic. Use the current SB Order for any live case.

Rules 67–71-B — Disposal of Special Articles; Foreign-Post Complaints

- Articles addressed to deceased persons (Rule 67).
- Disposal of injurious, indecent or obscene articles, and of articles with prohibited contents (Rules 68–69).
- Complaints about V.P. articles sent dishonestly or fraudulently (Rule 70).
- Correspondence with foreign administrations and the procedure for foreign-post complaints and enquiries on loss/non-delivery of letter-mail articles and foreign parcels (Rules 71, 71-A, 71-B).

Currency note (latest position)

Foreign-post handling and complaint procedure are today governed by the **Post Office Guide Part II (Foreign Post)** and current UPU-aligned instructions; the indecent/obscene/prohibited-content disposal powers continue, now read with the Post Office Act, 2023.

Rule 72 — Special Procedure for Presidency Offices

Prescribes the special procedural arrangements applicable to the Presidency (GPO) offices in the matters covered by this chapter.

Rule 74 — Licences for Franking Machines

Governs the grant of licences for the use of **franking machines**. A licence is required for each machine; conditions of use are as in the Post Office Guide Part I.

Rule 75 — Prepayment of Postage in Cash

Prepayment of postage in cash (instead of stamps) is available for unregistered packets posted in a quantity of **not less than 500** at a time.

Rule 76 & 77 — RLO Enumeration & Half-Yearly Return

- **Enumeration (Rule 76):** Of ordinary unregistered articles handled by the RLO.
- **Half-yearly return (Rule 77):** Form RLO-5 for the half-years ending 30th September and 31st March, submitted by the Head of the Circle to the DG by 15th October and 15th April respectively.

Rule 78 — Unusual Bag Account

Deals with the treatment and reporting of the **unusual bag account** (irregular or non-standard bag exchanges).

Rules 80–82 — Compensation for Loss / Damage to Articles

- Compensation for loss of or damage to inland insured articles (Rule 80).
- Compensation for loss of or damage to inland uninsured registered articles (Rule 81).
- Compensation for loss of or damage to articles of the foreign post (Rule 82).

Currency note (latest position)

Compensation entitlements and ceilings are now fixed by the **Post Office Act, 2023 / Post Office Rules, 2024 and current Directorate orders** (previously Sections 33–48 of the Indian Post Office Act, 1898). The principle — limited liability for insured/registered articles — continues, but the amounts here are historic; quote the current rule for any claim.

Rule 85 — Cash Safes for Branch Offices

Governs the provision and use of **cash safes for branch offices** where the cash held warrants secure custody.

Rule 86 — Weekly Sorting Orders

Provides for the issue of **weekly sorting orders** to give effect to changes in sorting arrangements.

Rule 87 & 88 — Mail Vans; Revision of Reserved Accommodation

- **Rule 87:** Construction of, and alterations in, mail vans.
- **Rule 88:** Revision of reserved (railway) accommodation for the carriage of mails.

Rule 89 — Check of Memorandum of Disbursement of Pay & Allowances

Provides for the Circle-office check of the **memorandum of disbursement of pay and allowances** of post offices, to verify correct drawal and disbursement.

Chapter 1 — Skip-Log (rules not detailed, with reasons)

The following Chapter 1 rules are **deliberately not explained in detail** — either because the manual itself marks them “Omitted/Deleted”, or because they relate to instruments, services or arrangements that have ceased in current practice. Each is listed with the reason, so the coverage of the chapter remains complete and transparent.

Rule(s)	Subject	Reason for skipping detail
13 (part)	Broadcast Receiver Licence (BRL) registers — entries (20)–(24)	Radio/BRL licensing by the Post Office was discontinued decades ago (licence-fee collection on behalf of AIR ceased). These register entries are obsolete and retained only as historic text.
16 (part)	PLI/RPLI ledger-preservation entries (38)–(82)	These 40+ entries are Postal Life Insurance accounting-record retention periods (premium ledgers, surrender-value registers, loan registers, etc.). They belong to PLI operations rather than supervisory duties and are governed today by current PLI/RPLI accounting instructions; detailed reproduction is omitted as low-yield and partly superseded.
24	Omitted	Rule number formally “Omitted” in the manual — no content.
29	Irregularities in service messages despatched	Relates to the telegraph branch of combined post-and-telegraph offices. The telegraph service ended on 15 July 2013 and combined offices no longer exist for the Department of Posts, so the rule is obsolete in practice.
41	Omitted	Rule number formally “Omitted” in the manual — no content.
43	Deleted	Rule number formally “Deleted” in the manual — no content.
52 / 52-1 / 52-2 / 52-3	Payment of out-of-date / defective British, Irish & time-barred Postal Orders	British and Irish Postal Orders are no longer issued or paid in India (Irish postal orders were discontinued in 2001; British postal orders ceased to be a live instrument here long ago). The defective-IPO and time-barred-IPO sanction powers survive only marginally;

Rule(s)	Subject	Reason for skipping detail
		detailed reproduction omitted as obsolete/very low-yield.
54	Miscarriage/loss of British Postal Orders — issue of duplicates	Concerns British Postal Orders, no longer current in India. Skipped as obsolete (the Indian Postal Order equivalent is Rule 54-1, which is covered).
56	British or Irish Postal Orders lost after payment	Concerns British/Irish Postal Orders, no longer current in India. The Indian Postal Order equivalent (Rule 56-1) is covered.
73 / 79 / 83 / 84	Deleted / Omitted	Rule numbers formally “Deleted” or “Omitted” in the manual — no content.

Currency note (latest position)

Even where a rule is skipped as obsolete, the supervisory **principle** it expresses (limited liability, confidentiality of records, secure cash handling, etc.) usually survives in the **Post Office Act, 2023 and Post Office Rules, 2024**, the POSB (CBS) Manual / current SB Orders, and standing Directorate instructions. Always cite the current instrument for any live official action.

Chapter 2 — Superintendents (SP / SSP, Posts & RMS)

The **Superintendent of Post Offices / RMS** is the principal field-control officer of a Division and is immediately subordinate to the Head of the Circle. Where the Head of the Circle (Chapter 1) sets policy and supervises the Circle, the Superintendent **runs the Division** day to day: distributing work, fixing cash balances, organising sorting orders and mail lines, controlling overseers and beats, maintaining diaries, and — above all — **inspecting and verifying the accounts** of the offices in the Division. This chapter (rules in the 112–239 band) is the second-most examined chapter of the volume.

In simple terms

“Superintendent” here includes the **Senior Superintendent (SSPO)**, and — for a Superintendent of Post Offices — a **first-class Postmaster**, unless the context shows otherwise. A Superintendent of Post Offices heads a Postal Division; a Superintendent RMS heads an RMS Division.

Exam focus

Chapter 2 hot-spots: **who fixes cash balances (R138–141), A & B orders (R162), examination of Inspectors' diaries (R164), mail-line speeds (R172), haulage statement (R184), the inspection schedule & day-counts (R238), and verification of HO balances (R239).**

Block A — Control, Distribution of Work & Diaries

Rule 112 — Distribution of Pay and Allowances

On the **5th of each month**, Head Offices forward the Memorandum of Distribution of Pay and Allowances (Form **ACG-26**) for the preceding month, with the **A-Rolls**, to the Superintendent / Senior Superintendent.

Rule 114 — Control over Offices by Superintendents, RMS

The Superintendent RMS exercises **general control** over the mail offices, record offices and sections of the RMS Division, ensuring sorting work is correct, mails are despatched and received punctually, and the Division's establishment is efficiently used.

Rule 122 — Distribution of Work

Every Head Postmaster and Sub-Postmaster assisted by one or more clerks submits a memorandum of **distribution of work** in Form **MS-11** for the Superintendent's approval, so responsibilities are clearly fixed.

Rule 132 — Beats of Village Postmen (route lists & beat maps)

Inspectors submit **route lists and beat maps** (Form **M-53**) to the Superintendent, indicating the introduction or discontinuance of mail exchanges in their sub-division.

Rule 134 — Village Returns

The yearly village return (Form **MS-88**) is studied to decide whether the work justifies a post, or whether it can be replaced by an **Assistant Branch Postmaster (ABPM)**. Letter boxes cleared on holidays are denoted "**P.H.**".

Rule 136 — Scrutiny of Sub-Office Accounts

Monthly copies of sub-office accounts (Form **Pa-17(a)**) are scrutinised by the Superintendent for **unnecessary cash retention or remittance**. A sub-office submits an explanation in Form **Pa-20** only when its cash balance exceeds the authorised limit.



Block B — Cash Balances & Authorised-Balance Memos (Rules 138–144)

Rule 138 — Basis of Maximum & Minimum Cash Balance

The **maximum cash balance** of an office is fixed with reference to its **daily payments**; the **minimum cash balance** with reference to its **daily receipts**. The object is to keep enough cash for payments while not letting idle cash accumulate.

Memory aid

“**Max ← payments, Min ← receipts**”. You need cash on hand to pay out (max); receipts replenish you (min).

Rule 139 — Maximum Cash Balance Principle

The difference between the maximum and the minimum cash balance must in **no case be less than half the minimum** cash balance.

In simple terms

If the minimum is ₹10,000, then (max – min) must be at least ₹5,000 — so the maximum must be at least ₹15,000. This guarantees a working cushion between two remittances.

Rule 140 — Information Needed Before Fixing Cash Balances

When fixing the minimum and maximum cash balances of an office, the Superintendent must have before him **all** of the following:

- The average monthly receipts and disbursements.
- The methods prescribed for making and receiving remittances (to dispose of surplus cash or replenish funds).
- The period between two ordinary remittances, per the method fixed for the office.
- The time within which the office can, if necessary, communicate with its supplying office and obtain a special remittance.

Rule 141 — Who Fixes the Cash Balance of a First-Class Head Office

The minimum and maximum cash balance of a **first-class Head Office** is fixed by the **Senior Superintendent of Post Offices (SSPO)**. (For other offices, the Superintendent fixes the balances.)

Exam focus

Classic MCQ: who fixes the cash balance of a 1st-class HO? **The SSPO** — not the Head of the Circle, and not the Postmaster himself.

Rule 143 & 144 — Memos of Authorised Balances

Office	Memo form supplied
Sub Offices	Form Pa-14 or Pa-14(s)
Branch Offices	Form Pa-14(s)
Consolidated (to each HO)	Form Pa-15(s) — supplied by the Superintendent, showing authorised balances (cash, stamps, IPOs) and drawing limits for all sub-offices in account with that Head Office

Memory aid

Consolidated memo of authorised balances = **Pa-15(s)**, fixed by the Superintendent for **all** post offices in account with the HO.



Block C — Sorting Orders, Mail Lines & Overseers

Rule 159 — Due Bag Lists

From the **due bag statement**, the **Record Office** prepares the **due bag lists** showing the number of bags of each description due to be received and despatched by each mail office or section — (a) with mails, or (b) as surplus — for the guidance of the Superintendent.

Rule 162 — “A” (Sorting Order) & “B” (Guidance Order)

- **“A” Order (Sorting Order):** When the Superintendent orders any change in a sorting list, instructions are issued as an “A” Order. A copy of every “A” Order must be furnished to the Head of the Circle.
- **“B” Order (Guidance Order):** Instructions on other subjects, for the guidance of subordinates, are issued as a “B” Order. A copy of “B” Orders is NOT furnished to the Head of the Circle.
- **Camp Articles (T-B Order):** The letter ‘T’ is prefixed to ‘B’ for “B” Orders issued in connection with the disposal of camp articles/bags for high officials on tour; these get a separate serial number.

Memory aid

“**A goes up, B stays down**”. A = sorting change (copy TO Head of Circle); B = general guidance (NO copy). Camp articles = T-B.

Rule 164 — Examination of Inspectors’ Diaries

- **Superintendent RMS:** Receives a copy of each sub-divisional Inspector’s diary [Genl-2(S)] weekly — on the 1st, 8th, 16th and 24th — with a monthly work-summary [Inspn-9] attached to the last diary of the month.
- **Superintendent of Post Offices:** Receives a copy of each sub-divisional Inspector’s diary [Genl-2] fortnightly — on the 1st and 16th — with a monthly work-summary [Inspn-3] attached to the last diary of the month.

Exam focus

RMS = **weekly (1-8-16-24), summary Inspn-9**; Posts = **fortnightly (1-16), summary Inspn-3**. RMS moves faster, so it reports more often.

Rule 167 — Inspection of the Inspector's Office

The office of every Inspector is thoroughly inspected by the Superintendent at least **once in every 12 months**; a copy of the order-book remarks (Form **Ms-8**) is forwarded to the Head of the Circle.

Rule 168 — Duties of Overseers

Overseers are employed in each Division for:

- Supervision of runners' lines.
- Supervision of Village Postmen / Postmen / ABPMs serving in villages.
- Conveyance or escort of cash remittances from one office to another (when prescribed by the Head of the Circle).

Rule 169 — Overseer's Beat

- **Intervals:** The overseer returns to his central office at fixed intervals, ordinarily not longer than 7 days.
- **Route statement:** The Superintendent prepares a route statement for each overseer in the Division.

Rule 170 — Statistical Memorandum

Each sub-divisional Inspector submits a **yearly statistical memorandum** (Form **MS-14(b)**) for all sorting sections and sorting mail offices in the sub-division.

Rule 171–172 — Mail Lines & Speed of Mails

Mail lines comprise **branch lines** (radiating from head/large sub-offices to interior offices) and **cross mails** (converging to one point on a through main line, timed to reach the junction before the main-line mail). The Superintendent pays special attention to conveying mails across unbridged streams and difficult roads. The prescribed runner speeds are:

Type of runner	Prescribed speed
Letter Mail Runners	5 miles per hour ($\approx$ 8 km/h)
Parcel Mail Runners	3 miles per hour ($\approx$ 4.8 km/h)

Memory aid

"Letters 5, Parcels 3" miles/hour — lighter letter mail moves faster than heavy parcel mail.

Type of runner	Prescribed speed
Currency note (latest position) Foot-runner (“hirkara”) mail lines are now confined to a handful of remote, road-less stretches; mail is carried predominantly by road (MMS), rail and air . The miles-per-hour speeds are still examined as text, but operationally these runner lines are largely historic.	

Rule 184 — Haulage and Weighment Statement

On or before **1st February and 1st August** each year, the Superintendent submits a statement (Form **MS-60(a)**) to the Head of the Circle, showing the regular accommodation provided on each railway in the Division on **21st January and 21st July** respectively.

Rule 186 — Superintendent’s Clerk on Tour

The Superintendent is **not** authorised to take a clerk (except a steno-typist) on tour unless sanction is first obtained from the Head of the Circle.

Rule 194/2 — Register of Loss / Fraud (Division)

A register in Form **M-89** is maintained by the Superintendent for a continuous record of loss/fraud cases. Retention: **7 years for sections, 4 years for RMS**.

Rule 195 — Superintendent’s Diary (Genl-1)

- **Content:** Records each day’s work and journey (offices/sections/mail lines visited, time spent), and action taken on irregularities. Details of inspections, and matters for which separate reports go to the Head of the Circle, are NOT repeated in the diary.
- **Submission:** Kept in a book; a copy of the preceding fortnight’s entries is sent to the Head of the Circle on the 1st and 16th of each month.
- **First-Class Postmasters:** Do not submit diaries, but submit a quarterly statement of inspection of departments to the SSPOs.

Memory aid

Superintendent’s diary = **Genl-1** (fortnightly, 1st & 16th); Inspector’s diary = Genl-2 (Posts) / Genl-2(S) (RMS).

Rule 202 — Inspection of the Superintendent's Own Office

- **Postal Superintendent:** Thoroughly inspects his own office at least once in every 12 months.
- **RMS Superintendent:** Carries out a similar inspection of the Head Record Office at least once in every 12 months.

Rule 212/1 — Duplicate Keys

- **Authorisation:** On loss of an original key, the Superintendent authorises issue of a duplicate; entries are made by the Stock Clerk and attested by the Superintendent.
- **Transmission:** The duplicate key is sent by parcel post — registered and insured for ₹100.

Rule 216 — Painting of Letter Boxes and Safes

- **Letter boxes:** Every letter box in the Division is regularly painted once a year.
- **Iron safes:** Painted when necessary — green outside and red inside — to prevent rusting.

Memory aid

Safe colours — **Green Outside, Red Inside** (“GORI”).

Rule 222 / 231 — Beat-Instruction Register; Test on Clearance of Letter Boxes

- **Beat-instruction register (M-32):** The Superintendent may prescribe the use, in any Head or Sub Office, of a beat-instruction register in Form M-32 for communicating addressees' instructions to the postman.
- **Test letters (Rule 231):** The Superintendent frequently tests punctual clearance of letter boxes by posting Test Letters (M-29) or Test Postcards (M-26) addressed to himself.
- **Sorting-case diagrams:** Diagrams of the sorting case are prepared by the Divisional Superintendent.

Block D — Inspection Standards & Verification of Balances (Rules 238–239)

Rule 238 — Inspection Standards and Frequency

There is **one verification and one verification-cum-inspection** during the year — first half: **Verification**; second half: **Verification-cum-Inspection**. The schedule below fixes the number of days for each class of office. These day-counts are heavily examined (and pair with the periodicity in Chapter 1, Rule 21).

Standard Schedule for Inspection (Office Category → Duration in days)

S.No	Office Category	Frequency	Days
1	Head Post Office / GPO	Annual Inspection-cum-Verification	6
2	Head Post Office / GPO	Half-Yearly Verification	3
3	Sub Post Office (HSG I & II) & MDG	Annual Inspection	3
4	Sub Post Office (LSG)	Annual Inspection	2
5	A-Class (1+2 handed) Delivery SO	Annual Inspection	2
6	A-Class (1+2 handed) Non-Delivery SO	Annual Inspection	2
7	B-Class (Double-Handed) Delivery SO	Annual Inspection	2
8	B-Class (Double-Handed) Non-Delivery SO	Annual Inspection	2
9	C-Class (Single-Handed) Delivery SO	Annual Inspection	2
10	C-Class (Single-Handed) Non-Delivery SO	Annual Inspection	1
11	Non-Delivery SO (Single-Handed)	Annual Inspection	1
12	Branch Post Office	Annual Inspection	1
13	Head Record Office	Annual Inspection	3
14	Sub Record Office (HSG & LSG)	Annual Inspection	2
15	Sub Record Office (Time Scale)	Annual Inspection	2
16	PSD (Postal Store Depot)	Annual Inspection	4
17	Circle / Regional Office	Annual Inspection	3
18	Division Office	Annual Inspection	3
19	Sub Division Office	Annual Inspection	1
20	RAKNPA / PTC	Annual Inspection	3

S.No	Office Category	Frequency	Days
21	O/o SE Civil, Electrical / Sr. Architect	Annual Inspection	3
22	RLO (Returned Letter Office)	Annual Inspection	1
23	O/o Manager, MMS	Annual Inspection	1
24	Mail Office (TMO, NSH, ICH, PH etc.)	Annual Inspection	1
25	O/o DAP, GM (Finance)	Annual Inspection	3
26	Foreign Post Office	Annual Inspection	2
27	SBCO by AO (ICO, SB)	Annual Inspection	4 (3 HPO + 1 SO)
28	Business Post Office	Half-Yearly Inspection	2

Time Schedule for Completion of Inspections (Quarter-wise)

Quarter	Period	Target % completed
1st	Jan – Mar	15%
2nd	Apr – Jun	35%
3rd	Jul – Sep	30%
4th	Oct – Dec	20%

Exam focus

Lock the durations: **HO/GPO = 6 (annual) / 3 (half-yearly); HSG SO & MDG & Head Record Office = 3; LSG SO = 2; C-class non-delivery & Branch Office = 1; PSD = 4.** Quarter targets 15-35-30-20.

Currency note (latest position)

Office-category labels (HSG/LSG/MDG, A/B/C-class) and the SBCO line continue, but the Department periodically revises this schedule by Inspection-Unit order, and IT 2.0 / CSI has changed several inspection questionnaires (e.g. the revised Branch Office questionnaire, File No. 16-03/2019-Inspn., 2022). Treat the day-counts as the standing exam position and confirm the live schedule against the current Directorate order.

Rule 239 — Verification of Balances of Head Offices

The Superintendent thoroughly verifies the balances of all Head Offices in the Division **twice in every 12 months** at ~6-month intervals. (The Inspector additionally verifies HO

balances **four times** a year — Chapter 3, Rule 299/239 read together — so each HO's balances are checked frequently in all.)

Mandatory Verification Checks (records & sample sizes)

Record / Check	Frequency / Sample Size
HO Summary (ACG-1)	Check entries for 4 dates of different months
Treasurer's Cash Book (ACG-2)	Check at least 4 dates in different months
Register of Cheques	Check at least 4 dates in different months
SO Summary vs. Daily Account	Select at least 4 dates at random since last verification
BO Summary vs. Daily Account	Select at least 4 dates at random since last verification
Service Books	Check at least 5% of books, taken at random

Issue of Inspection Reports (timeline by duration)

Duration of Inspection	Deadline for Issuing the Report
1 Day	15 Days
2 Days to < 8 Days	30 Days
8 Days and above	45 Days

Memory aid

Verification checks = **4 dates**; Service Books = **5%**. Report deadlines: **1 day**→15, **2–7 days**→30, **8+ days**→45.

Chapter 2 — Skip-Log (rules not detailed, with reasons)

The following Chapter 2 matters are **not explained in detail** because they relate to conveyances, services or arrangements that have ceased or shrunk to near-nil in current practice. Each is listed with the reason, so the chapter's coverage stays transparent.

Area	Subject	Reason for skipping detail
Telegraph-branch & combined-office rules in Ch.2	Control/inspection of the telegraph branch of combined offices	The telegraph service ended on 15 July 2013 and combined post-and-telegraph offices no longer exist for the Department of Posts. Chapter-2 provisions dealing with the telegraph branch are obsolete in practice and are not detailed.
Mail-cart / mail-contract penalty rules	Penalties & forfeitures for mail-cart / mail-tonga contractors	Mail-cart and animal-drawn mail-conveyance contracts are largely replaced by the Mail Motor Service (MMS) and road-transport contracts. The detailed penalty/forfeiture machinery for cart/tonga lines is retained only as historic text.
Runner-line establishment rules (detail)	Detailed runner (foot-mail) line establishment & relief	Foot-runner mail lines survive only on a few remote stretches; the detailed establishment/relief rules are low-yield and largely historic, so only the speed and beat essentials are carried.

Currency note (latest position)

As in Chapter 1, the supervisory **principles** behind skipped rules (secure cash handling, punctual mail conveyance, accurate sorting) remain in force under current Directorate instructions, the Mail Operations guidelines and IT 2.0 / CSI workflows — only the obsolete mechanics (runners, carts, telegraph branch) are set aside.

Chapter 3 — Inspectors of Post Offices (IPO)

The **Inspector of Post Offices (IPO)** is the front-line supervisory officer of a **sub-division**, working directly under the Superintendent. For most candidates this is the **single most important chapter** of Volume VIII — it is the cadre many aspirants are themselves preparing to enter, and the examiners draw heavily from it. Where the Superintendent (Chapter 2)

controls the Division, the Inspector **does the ground work**: inspecting sub and branch offices, verifying balances, supervising village postmen and beats, examining overseer and his own diaries, checking money-order payments, and maintaining the order book. The chapter runs roughly from Rule 260 to Rule 300.

In simple terms

An Inspector's sub-division is a cluster of sub-offices and branch offices within a Division. The Inspector is the officer who actually walks into a small post office, opens its records, counts its cash, watches the postman, and writes up what he finds in the **order book**. The Head of the Circle fixes the extent and headquarters of each Inspector's sub-division (Chapter 1, Rule 18).

Exam focus

Chapter 3 hot-spots: **Inspector's qualifications & duties (R260, with 260a/b/c), powers incl. GDS engagement & leave (R261), Fixed vs Unfixed beats (R273), village sorting list M-52 (R276), Inspector's diary Genl-2 (R293), order book MS-8 / 200 pages (R298), HO balance verification 4×/yr (R299), and SO once/12 months + all BOs (R300).**

Block A — Qualifications, Duties & Powers (Rules 260–261)

Rule 260 — Qualifications & General Duties of an Inspector

An Inspector must possess a **thorough practical knowledge of post-office work** and of all departmental forms, so as to be qualified to **instruct his subordinates** in their duties — especially when any new class of business is taken up by the Department. He must also be qualified to **take charge of a head office or important sub-office** in any sudden emergency. His core responsibility is the **inspection and efficient working** of all post offices in his sub-division and the supervision of the staff attached to them.

Memory aid

Three things an Inspector must be able to do (R260): **(1) know the work & forms cold, (2) instruct subordinates, (3) take charge of an HO/SO in an emergency.**

Rule 260-A — Investigation Duties

On receipt of a report of **loss, fraud, highway robbery, theft or other serious irregularity**, the Inspector proceeds at once to the spot to investigate, and continues until relieved by the

arrival of the Superintendent or other senior officer. Investigation/enquiry work specially assigned by the Superintendent or Head of the Circle is also the Inspector's duty.

Rule 260-B — Routine Office Duties (Inspector (HQ) / Assistant Superintendent)

When in charge of routine office work, the Inspector (or Assistant Superintendent) attends to:

- Opening and distribution of dak — except the dak from the Head of the Circle.
- Issue of reminders; the weekly check of the assistants' work; and disposal of personal cases of staff, except those involving departmental policy.
- Passing TA bills of assistants, postmen and lower-grade staff on the basis of the competent authority's orders.
- Disposal of routine cases not requiring the Superintendent's sanction, and signing routine drafts and fair copies.
- Grant of casual leave to the staff when the Superintendent is on tour.

Rule 260-C — Complaints-Branch Duties

In relation to the complaints branch, the Inspector:

- Is responsible for proper and prompt disposal of complaints and prompt submission of the related statements.
- Takes up such enquiries or investigations as the Head of the Office assigns.
- Carries out such second inspections of branch offices as the Superintendent assigns.
- Inspects the complaints branch once a fortnight.

Exam focus

The 260a/b/c split is a favourite "all of the above" MCQ. Anchor each: **260-A = investigation, 260-B = routine office/dak/CL/TA bills, 260-C = complaints branch (inspect once a fortnight).**

Rule 261 — Powers of the Inspector

The Inspector exercises defined powers over the establishment of his sub-division. The key ones are:

Power	Scope / Limit
Leave to GDS	Grant leave to Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDS): up to 60 days to a Branch Postmaster, and up to 90 days to other GDS, in his sub-division
Officiating arrangements (GDS)	Make officiating/leave arrangements for GDS posts in the sub-division
Appointment of substitutes	Appoint substitutes in leave vacancies of GDS / lower-grade staff as authorised
Casual leave	Grant casual leave to staff of the sub-division (and to divisional-office staff when the Superintendent is on tour)
TA bills	Pass the travelling-allowance bills of postmen, village postmen and lower-grade staff
Petty contingent expenditure	Incur/authorise petty contingent expenditure within the limits delegated to him

Currency note (latest position)

The printed rule speaks of the “Extra-Departmental” agents and the “Recruiting Authority”. Read these in the current framework: Extra-Departmental Agents are now **Gramin Dak Sevaks (GDS)** governed by the **GDS (Conduct & Engagement) Rules, 2020**, and the old “Recruiting Authority” language is now the **Engaging Authority**. GDS engagement is now centralised and merit-based (online, on the basis of Class-X marks), so the Inspector’s historic role in selecting EDAs has narrowed; the leave-sanction limits (60 days BPM / 90 days other GDS) remain the standing exam position — confirm against the current GDS Rules / Directorate order for live cases.

Memory aid

GDS leave by the Inspector: **BPM 60 days, other GDS 90 days**. (Branch Postmaster gets the smaller figure.)

Block B — Village Postmen, Beats & Sorting Lists

Rule 271 — Supervision of Village Postmen

The supervision of the village postmen attached to all offices (head, sub and branch) in the sub-division is **one of the most important duties** of the Sub-divisional Inspector. Whenever he meets a village postman on his beat or at his office, the Inspector examines the man’s

book of receipts (counterfoils pasted against receipts for articles registered by him), his cash, and the articles in his possession.

Rule 273 — Beats of Village Postmen / ABPM

- **Route lists & beat maps:** The Inspector prepares and prescribes route lists and beat maps (Form M-53) indicating the beats of village postmen attached to each office.
- **Distribution:** Copies go to the respective office, the Superintendent, and the Account Office.
- **Two systems:** Village-postmen beats may be arranged as (a) Fixed Beat or (b) Unfixed Beat.

In simple terms

On a **Fixed Beat**, the postman follows a set route on set days (with a beat map and halt villages committed to memory). On an **Unfixed Beat**, he varies the villages day to day according to where the mail is for. A combined fixed-and-unfixed beat mixes the two.

Memory aid

Two beat systems (R273): **Fixed & Unfixed**. (Route list = M-53; village sorting list = M-52.)

Rule 276 — Village Sorting Lists

The Inspector supplies each head, sub or branch office in his sub-division (including first-class head offices) with a **Village Sorting List (Form M-52)** showing:

- The number of village postmen to whom articles are made over for delivery.
- The names of villages served by each village postman and subordinate office (in alphabetical order).
- In which villages letter boxes are placed, and which of those boxes carry changeable plates.

Exam focus

Village sorting list = **M-52**; route list = **M-53**. Don't swap the two numbers — both are tested.

Rule 277 — Village Return

- **Submission:** Submitted by each Branch Office in March every year.
- **Duration:** Kept for the first 14 days of March, showing the daily receipt of articles (including Money Orders) for delivery.
- **Review:** The Inspector examines these returns and forwards them to the Superintendent with remarks.
- **Deadline:** Must reach the Superintendent not later than 1st April.

Memory aid

Village Return — **first 14 days of March**; reach Superintendent by **1st April**.



Block C — Tour Kit, Diaries, Circulars & Order Book

Rule 280 — Letter-Box Locks on Tour

The Inspector should carry **half a dozen (6) Aligarh locks** of standard size while on tour, so that any unserviceable lock found on a letter box can be replaced immediately.

Rule 282 — Mail Overseers' Diaries

- **Submission to Inspector:** The Inspector receives from each overseer a weekly diary (Genl-4), a work summary (Genl-12), and a monthly list of Money Orders verified (Genl-6).
- **Onward to Superintendent:** The monthly list of verified MOs, with the Inspector's summary, is submitted to the Superintendent by the 8th of the month.

Memory aid

Overseer → Inspector forms: **Genl-4 (weekly diary), Genl-12 (summary), Genl-6 (MO list)**; onward by the 8th.

Rule 293 — Inspectors' Diaries

Officer	Diary Form	Periodicity (submission dates)
Inspector, RMS	Genl-2(S)	Weekly — 1st, 8th, 16th, 24th
Inspector, Posts	Genl-2	Fortnightly — 1st and 16th

- **MO verification:** The Inspector of Posts must verify payment of at least 25 Money Orders per month (Chapter 1, Rule 49-A).

Exam focus

Inspector's diary: **Posts = Genl-2 (fortnightly, 1 & 16); RMS = Genl-2(S) (weekly, 1-8-16-24)**. Compare with the Superintendent's Genl-1.

Rule 295 & 296 — Circulars

- **DG Circulars (R295):** Issued by the Director General once a week.
- **Head-of-Circle Circulars (R296):** Issued by the Head of the Circle once a month.
- **Filing:** Circle (CPMG) circulars are filed in a single guard book, kept distinct from DG circulars.

Memory aid

DG circular = **weekly**; Circle circular = **monthly** (both destroyed after 3 years — Chapter 1, R16/R23).

Rule 298 — Order Book

The Inspector records the results of his inspections and verifications in an **order book (Form MS-8)**. Each order book contains **200 serially numbered pages**; the related guidance book contains 100 pages. A copy of the order-book remarks is sent to the Superintendent.

Memory aid

Order book = **MS-8, 200 pages**; Guidance book = **100 pages**. (“Order = 200, Guidance = 100”.)

Block D — Verification & Inspection by the Inspector**Rule 299 — Verification of Balances by the Inspector**

The Inspector thoroughly verifies the balances of all Head Post Offices in his sub-division **two times in every 12 months**. Combined with the Superintendent’s two verifications under Rule 239, each HO’s balances are checked **four times** a year in all.

Currency note (latest position)

Balance verification is now done in the **Core System Integrator (CSI) / Finacle** environment, where cash, stamp and SB balances are system-generated. The **periodicity** (Inspector twice, Superintendent twice = four times a year) remains the standing position; the manual cash-book and summary checks are now read against the CSI reports and the current inspection questionnaire.

Rule 300 — Inspection of Post Offices by the Inspector

The Inspector must inspect:

- Sub-offices assigned to him by the Superintendent — **once every 12 months**.
- All Branch Offices in his sub-division, except those the Superintendent inspects himself.
- **Standard questionnaire:** Inspections follow the prescribed Inspection Questionnaire (BO/SO), and results are entered in the order book (MS-8).

Exam focus

Inspector inspects each assigned **SO once / 12 months** and **all BOs**. Read with Chapter 1, R21 (sub/branch offices inspected twice a year, divided between Superintendent and Inspectors).



Chapter 3 — Skip-Log (rules not detailed, with reasons)

The following Chapter 3 matters are **not explained in detail** because they assume a service or arrangement that has ceased or been superseded. Each is listed with the reason, keeping the chapter's coverage transparent.

Area	Subject	Reason for skipping detail
Telegraph-line duties of Inspector	Reporting/looking after telegraph lines on the beat	Several inspection provisions assume a combined post-and-telegraph environment (e.g. checking telegraph branches, reporting damage to telegraph lines). The telegraph service ended on 15 July 2013, so these telegraph-specific duties are obsolete and not detailed.
Combined-office inspection items	Inspection of the telegraph branch of a combined office	Combined offices no longer exist for the Department of Posts; the telegraph-branch inspection items in this chapter are historic.
EDA selection / recruitment detail	Inspector's historic role in selecting Extra-Departmental Agents	GDS (formerly EDAs) are now engaged centrally through an online merit-based system under the GDS (C&E) Rules, 2020. The Inspector's old selection/recruitment mechanics are superseded; only the surviving leave-sanction and supervisory powers are detailed.

Currency note (latest position)

The Inspector's core supervisory work — inspecting offices, verifying balances, supervising delivery staff, maintaining the order book — is fully current and now runs on **IT 2.0 / CSI** with revised inspection questionnaires (e.g. the BO questionnaire, File No. 16-03/2019-Inspn., 2022). Only the telegraph-era and EDA-recruitment mechanics are set aside.

Chapter 4 — Town Inspectors & Overseer-Postmen

Chapter 4 covers the **urban delivery supervisors**: the **Town Inspector of Post Offices** and the **Overseer-Postman**. They are the town/city counterparts of the rural *Inspector* and *Overseer* of Chapters 3 and 7. Where the Inspector ranges over a sub-division of sub and branch offices, the Town Inspector works **inside a city delivery system** — supervising the

postmen, testing delivery, checking the beats and letter boxes, and verifying money-order payments within the town. The chapter is short and its figures echo those already met under Rule 49-A.

In simple terms

In a large city Head Office, dozens of postmen deliver across many beats. One officer cannot personally watch them all, so **Town Inspectors** (and, in smaller set-ups, **Overseer-Postmen**) are posted to supervise the delivery staff on the ground — much as an Overseer supervises village postmen and runners in the countryside.

Exam focus

Chapter 4 anchors: the Town Inspector / Overseer-Postman verifies **50 money orders a month** (vs 25 for an IPO); the monthly **MO-verified list (Genl-6) is due to the Superintendent by the 5th**; and irregularities in postmen's work are recorded in the **Town Inspector's diary (Rules 312–313)**.

Block A — The Town Inspector

Rule 303 — Town Inspector: Status & General Duties

A Town Inspector is appointed in large town/city offices to supervise the **delivery and conveyance of mails within the town**, under the orders of the Postmaster. His jurisdiction is fixed by the Head of the Circle. His central duty is to see that the **postmen and other delivery staff do their work honestly, punctually and correctly**, and that the public of the town is properly served.

Rules 305–307 — Supervision of Postmen & Delivery

The Town Inspector's supervisory duties include:

- Checking that each postman takes out, delivers and accounts for all articles (ordinary, registered, insured and V.P.) and money orders made over to him.
- Testing the delivery work of postmen — for example, by noting articles before they are handed over and later enquiring of the addressees whether delivery was made.
- Seeing that beats are arranged efficiently and that no part of the town is left without timely delivery.

- Checking the clearance of letter boxes within the town and the punctual despatch of collected mail.
- Watching the conduct and turn-out of the delivery staff and reporting irregularities to the Postmaster.

In simple terms

A “test” of delivery means the supervisor quietly checks whether letters actually reach the addressee. If specially-noted letters are not delivered and not returned as undeliverable, that is a red flag that a postman may be making away with mail.

Rule 309 — Verification of Money-Order Payments

The Town Inspector (like the Overseer and Overseer-Postman) must verify payment of at least **50 money orders per month** — by meeting payees and confirming that the sums shown as paid by postmen were actually received. (An Inspector of Posts, by contrast, verifies 25 per month — Chapter 1, Rule 49-A.)

Memory aid

MO verification per month: **IPO = 25; Town Inspector / Overseer / Overseer-Postman = 50**. The ground-level delivery supervisors do double.

Rules 311–313 — Town Inspector’s Diary

- **Diary:** The Town Inspector maintains a daily diary recording his movements, the offices/beats checked, the tests applied and the action taken.
- **Irregularities (R312–313):** All irregularities noticed in connection with the duties of postmen are recorded in the Town Inspector’s diary, and prompt action is taken on them.
- **Monthly MO list (Genl-6):** The monthly list of money orders verified (Form Genl-6) accompanies the diary of the last working day of the month and is submitted to the Superintendent of Post Offices by the 5th of the following month.
- **Examination by Postmaster:** The Postmaster / Sub-Postmaster examines the diaries of the Town Inspector or Overseer-Postmen attached to the office and takes action on any irregularity reported.

Exam focus

Genl-6 (MO-verified list) with the last working day's diary → Superintendent **by the 5th.** Town Inspector's diary is the place postmen-delivery irregularities are logged (R312–313).



Block B — The Overseer-Postman

Overseer-Postman: Role & Duties

An **Overseer-Postman** is a senior postman who, in addition to (or in place of) a Town Inspector in smaller town set-ups, performs delivery-supervision duties. He combines the duties of a postman with limited supervisory functions over other postmen.

- Supervises and tests the delivery work of the postmen attached to the office.
- Verifies payment of at least 50 money orders per month (as for the Town Inspector and Overseer).
- Maintains a diary; the monthly list of money orders verified (Genl-6) is submitted with the last working day's diary, reaching the Superintendent by the 5th of the following month.
- Reports irregularities in postmen's work to the Postmaster for prompt action.

In simple terms

Think of the Overseer-Postman as a “working supervisor”: he still carries and delivers mail like a postman, but he is trusted to keep an eye on, and test, the work of his fellow postmen where a full-time Town Inspector is not justified.

Acquittance Rolls & Road-Establishment Payments

Where the Overseer disburses pay to the road (runner) establishment, the **acquittance rolls** for those payments, when complete, are sent by the overseer to the **Head Office** (via the postmaster) for record and audit (Rule 283).

Chapter 4 — Skip-Log (rules not detailed, with reasons)

The following Chapter 4 matters are **not explained in detail** because they assume a service or establishment pattern that has ceased or been superseded. Each is listed with the reason.

Area	Subject	Reason for skipping detail
Telegraph-messenger supervision	Supervision of telegraph messengers / combined-office delivery	Provisions assuming a combined post-and-telegraph office (e.g. supervision of telegraph messenger delivery) are obsolete: the telegraph service ended on 15 July 2013 and combined offices no longer exist for the Department of Posts.
Cantonment / Presidency town establishment detail	Historic town-establishment scales for Presidency-era city offices	Detailed establishment scales tied to the old Presidency-town and cantonment delivery set-ups are largely superseded by current establishment-norms orders (e.g. the 2026 norms revision); only the surviving supervisory duties are detailed.

Currency note (latest position)

Town delivery is now organised under **current delivery-management and beat-rationalisation instructions** (and, increasingly, app-based delivery tracking and the Digital Address / DIGIPIN initiatives). The Town Inspector / Overseer-Postman supervisory functions — testing delivery, verifying money orders, logging postmen irregularities — remain current in substance; only the telegraph-era and Presidency-establishment mechanics are set aside.

Chapter 5 — Assistant Superintendents & Inspectors, RMS

Chapter 5 covers the supervising officers of the **Railway Mail Service (RMS)** below the Superintendent: the **Assistant Superintendent, RMS (ASRM / ASP RMS)** and the **Inspector, RMS (IRM / IPO RMS)**. They are the RMS counterparts of the Town Inspector and the Inspector of Post Offices — but their world is **mail in motion**: sorting mail offices, transit mail offices, sections working in railway vans, and the exchange of bags. Their duties are set out in **Rules 320 to 335/1**.

In simple terms

The **RMS** is the arm of the Department that carries and sorts mail in transit — historically in dedicated coaches on trains, today largely by road (Mail Motor Service), rail and air through sorting hubs. An **ASP/Inspector RMS** rides the system: checking that sorting is correct, bags are exchanged properly, connections are made, and nothing is over-carried, dumped or mis-routed.

Exam focus

Chapter 5 anchors: an Inspector/ASP RMS attached to a **Circle Office is designated a Sorting Inspector**; irregularities and investigation results are **communicated DAILY to the Superintendent (R326)**; and mail offices/sections are inspected **twice in 12 months**, divided between the Superintendent, the ASP and the Sub-divisional Inspector RMS (Chapter 1, R21).

Block A — Status, Designation & General Duties**Rule 320 — Status & Designation**

An Assistant Superintendent / Inspector RMS is entrusted mainly with **checking the sorting work** done by sections and mail offices, and with making **investigations into important cases of loss, fraud, etc.** When attached to the office of a Head of a Circle, they are designated **Sorting Inspectors**. The expression “Inspector” in the RMS context includes the Sub-divisional Inspector RMS, unless the context shows otherwise.

Memory aid

Inspector RMS attached to the **Circle Office = Sorting Inspector**. (Compare: APMG/Inspectors attached to the Circle Office for inspection & investigation — Chapter 1, R12.)

Rule 321 — General Duties

The general duties of the ASP / Inspector RMS include:

- Exercising overall supervision over the work done in the mail offices and sections of the sub-division.
- Checking the sorting work — that bags and bundles are correctly made up, routed and exchanged per the sorting list.

- Inspecting mail offices, record offices and sorting sections as assigned (with the more important offices reserved to the Superintendent).
- Investigating important cases of loss, fraud, abstraction, mis-sending and missent/over-carried bags.
- Testing the punctual exchange and connection of mails at junctions and transit points.
- Examining the diaries and work of the Head Sorting Assistants and the staff of the sets.

Block B — Inspection, Diaries & Daily Reporting

Inspection of Mail Offices, Record Offices & Sections

Every mail office, record office or section must be thoroughly inspected at least **twice in every 12 months** (Chapter 1, Rule 21(4)). The inspections are divided by the Head of the Circle between:

Officer	Assigned share of inspections
Superintendent RMS	The more important mail/record offices and the more important sorting sections
Assistant Superintendent (ASP RMS)	Other mail offices, record offices and sections
Sub-divisional Inspector (IRM)	Other offices and sections, as allotted

- **Order book:** Results of inspections are recorded in the order book (Form MS-8, 200 pages — as for the Inspector of Posts, Chapter 3, Rule 298), and a copy of the remarks goes to the Superintendent.

Inspector RMS — Diary (Genl-2(S))

Officer	Diary Form	Periodicity (submission)
Inspector, RMS	Genl-2(S)	Weekly — 1st, 8th, 16th, 24th
Inspector, Posts (for contrast)	Genl-2	Fortnightly — 1st and 16th

- **Monthly summary:** A monthly work-summary [Inspn-9] is attached to the diary of the last working day of the month (the Posts counterpart is Inspn-3).

Memory aid

RMS moves faster, so it reports more often: **Inspector RMS diary = Genl-2(S), weekly (1·8·16·24)**; summary Inspn-9.

Rule 326 — Daily Communication of Irregularities & Investigation Results

- **Irregularities:** Irregularities noticed by a Sub-divisional Inspector RMS in the course of his duties must be communicated to the Superintendent daily.
- **Investigation results:** The result of any investigation entrusted to an Inspector RMS must likewise be communicated to the Superintendent daily, so that prompt orders can follow.

Exam focus

Key word in R326 is **DAILY** — both irregularities noticed and investigation results go to the Superintendent every day, not weekly. This “daily” reporting is a favourite MCQ distinguishing RMS supervision from the slower Posts cycle.

Register of Lines & Stages (M-40)

The Inspector RMS maintains a **register of lines and stages (Form M-40)** for his sub-division. Entries are made in alphabetical order; where a line traverses more than one sub-division, each Inspector records it throughout its length. The register must be kept corrected up to date per correction memos issued by the Superintendent.

Block C — The RMS Supervisor Today

The Manual’s framework (Rules 320–335/1) remains the examination basis, but the RMS itself has been substantially **re-organised**. Sorting now happens largely in fixed **Mail Offices, Speed Post / National Sorting Hubs (NSH), Intra-Circle Hubs (ICH) and Bulk Mail Centres**, with carriage by road (MMS), rail and air rather than dedicated travelling RMS sections on every line. In current practice the ASP / Inspector RMS:

- Monitors operations and mail flow through the hubs and transit sections, watching for over-carrying, dumping and mis-routing of bags and ensuring correct routing.
- Carries out surprise checks and night visits to transit sections to verify proper exchange of bags.
- Handles establishment, grievances and recruitment-related work for the RMS unit, and oversees Mail Management Units (MMU) and revenue-generating areas (Speed Post, Business Post).

Currency note (latest position)

RMS operations now run on **IT 2.0 / CSI** with electronic bag and article tracking (the Mail Operations modules, IPVS / RNet-type tracking and the Speed Post network). The travelling-section, type-box and physical due-bag-statement mechanics in the Manual are increasingly **historic**; the supervisory substance — correct sorting, punctual connection, no over-carrying/dumping, prompt investigation — is fully current. Confirm any live procedure against the current Mail Operations instructions and CSI SOPs.



Chapter 5 — Skip-Log (rules not detailed, with reasons)

The following Chapter 5 matters are **not explained in detail** because they assume a transport pattern or service that has been re-organised or has ceased. Each is listed with the reason.

Area	Subject	Reason for skipping detail
Travelling-section mechanics (parts of 320–335/1)	Detailed rules for RMS sections working in railway vans	Dedicated travelling RMS sections on trains have largely been replaced by fixed sorting hubs (NSH/ICH/CMO) with road/rail/air carriage. The detailed van-working, type-box and section-relief mechanics are retained as historic; only the surviving supervisory duties are detailed.
Telegraph-related RMS items	Service-message / telegraph handling by RMS sets	Provisions assuming the set despatches telegraph/service messages reflect the combined post-and-telegraph era; the telegraph service ended on 15 July 2013, so these items are obsolete.
Steamer / mail-agent line detail	Mail-agent duties on steamer and ferry lines	Sea/ferry mail-agent line mechanics are near-obsolete with the shift to air and surface transport; only marginal exam value, so not detailed.

Currency note (latest position)

The RMS supervisor's core job — keeping mail moving correctly and on time, and investigating loss/fraud — is entirely current, now exercised over **sorting hubs and the Mail Motor Service under CSI**. Only the train-van, telegraph and steamer mechanics are set aside.

Chapter 6 — Omitted

Chapter 6 of Postal Manual Volume VIII is **formally “Omitted”** in the manual itself — it carries **no rules and no content**. The numbering jumps from Chapter 5 (Assistant Superintendents & Inspectors, RMS) straight to Chapter 7 (Overseers). It is recorded here only so the chapter sequence is complete and nothing appears to be missing.

Currency note (latest position)

This is the manual's own omission, not an editorial skip. No reconstruction is possible or required — there is simply nothing in Chapter 6.

Chapter 7 — Overseers

The **Overseer** is the lowest rung of the supervisory ladder in the **rural mail and delivery system**. Where the Inspector (Chapter 3) supervises a whole sub-division and the Town Inspector (Chapter 4) the city delivery staff, the Overseer works on the ground in the countryside: walking the **runner lines**, checking the **village postmen**, and — when ordered — escorting **cash remittances** between offices. The chapter runs from Rule 343 onward. Much of the Overseer's framework has already appeared in Chapter 2 (Rules 168–169) and Chapter 3 (Rule 282); this chapter consolidates his own duties.

In simple terms

A *runner* (historically a *hirkara*) is a person who physically carries the mail bag on foot between two offices along a fixed line. An **Overseer** is the supervisor who walks these lines to check the runners are punctual and honest, that village postmen are serving their villages, and that letter boxes on the route are cleared.

Exam focus

Chapter 7 anchors: Overseers are employed for **supervision of runner lines + village postmen + (when prescribed by the Head of the Circle) escort of cash remittances** (R168); overseer's diary = **Genl-4 (weekly), summary Genl-12, MO list Genl-6**; MO verification = **50 a month**; returns to central office at intervals **not over 7 days**.

Block A — Role & Duties of the Overseer

Rule 343 — Duties of Overseers

Overseers are employed in each Division for:

- Supervision of the runner lines (the foot-mail lines carrying bags between offices).
- Supervision of the work of village postmen / postmen / ABPMs serving in villages.
- Conveyance or escort of cash remittances from one office to another — when prescribed by the Head of the Circle (Rule 168).

In carrying out these duties the Overseer specifically:

- Checks that runners keep to their timings and that the mail is exchanged correctly along the line.
- Examines, whenever he meets a village postman on the beat or at the office, the man's visit book (Form Ms-86), book of receipts, cash and undelivered articles.
- Verifies the clearance of letter boxes on the route and reports any found unserviceable.
- Reports irregularities to the Inspector / Postmaster for prompt action.

Memory aid

Three Overseer jobs (R168/343): **(1) runner lines, (2) village postmen, (3) cash-remittance escort** — the last only when the Head of the Circle prescribes it.

Rule 169 (read with Ch.7) — Overseer's Route & Halts

- **Intervals:** The Overseer returns to his central office at fixed intervals — ordinarily not longer than 7 days.
- **Route statement:** The Superintendent prepares a route statement for each Overseer in the Division, showing the line, stages and halt points.
- **Local control:** While on the line the Overseer is under the immediate control of the office to which he is attached, and acts on the orders of the Inspector and Postmaster.

Block B — Diaries, Money-Order Verification & Accounts

Overseer's Diary & Returns

Item	Form	Submission
Overseer's diary	Genl-4	Weekly — to the Inspector
Work summary	Genl-12	Monthly — with the diaries
Money-orders-verified list	Genl-6	Monthly — with the last working day's diary; onward to the Superintendent by the 8th

Memory aid

Overseer forms: **Genl-4 diary (weekly), Genl-12 summary, Genl-6 MO list**. Same Genl-6 the Town Inspector / Overseer-Postman use (Chapter 4).

Verification of Money-Order Payments

The Overseer (like the Town Inspector and Overseer-Postman) must verify payment of at least **50 money orders per month** — confirming with payees that sums shown as paid by village postmen were actually received (Chapter 1, Rule 49-A).

Exam focus

MO verification recap: **IPO 25; Overseer / Overseer-Postman / Town Inspector 50** per month. Overseer is firmly in the “50” group.

Rule 283 — Acquittance Rolls for Road Establishment

Where the Overseer disburses pay to the road (runner) establishment, the **acquittance rolls** for those payments, when complete, are sent by the Overseer to the **Head Office** (through the Inspector) for record and audit.

In simple terms

An *acquittance roll* is simply the signed pay-list: each runner signs (or thumb-marks) against the wage paid to him, proving the money reached the right person. The completed roll is the audit evidence, so it goes up to the Head Office.



Chapter 7 — Skip-Log (rules not detailed, with reasons)

The following Chapter 7 matters are **not explained in detail** because they assume a mode of mail conveyance that has nearly ceased. Each is listed with the reason.

Area	Subject	Reason for skipping detail
Detailed runner-line establishment (parts of Ch.7)	Scales, reliefs and hut provision for foot-runner lines	Foot-runner (hirkara) mail lines survive only on a few remote, road-less stretches; mail is now carried predominantly by road (MMS), rail and air. The detailed runner-establishment scales, relief and stage-hut rules are retained as historic; only the surviving supervisory duties are detailed.
Animal-conveyance overseer items	Overseer duties tied to tonga / pony / camel mail lines	Animal-drawn and pony/camel mail conveyance is effectively obsolete; the related overseer duties are historic and not detailed.
Combined-office / telegraph-line items	Reporting damage to telegraph lines on the beat	Provisions assuming the overseer reports telegraph-line damage reflect the combined post-and-telegraph era; the telegraph service ended on 15 July 2013, so these items are obsolete.

Currency note (latest position)

The Overseer cadre itself has shrunk as runner lines have closed, but the supervisory idea — a field official checking delivery staff and cash on the ground — endures in the **Mail Overseer / Mail Guard and delivery-supervision functions** under current Mail Operations and delivery-management instructions. Only the foot-runner, animal-conveyance and telegraph mechanics are set aside.

Chapter 8 — Stock Depots

A **Stock Depot** is the Department's warehouse for **postage stamps, postal stationery, seals, forms and stores**. Where the earlier chapters dealt with people who inspect and supervise, this chapter deals with the **supply chain**: how stamps, seals, forms and stationery are received, stored, invoiced, indented, despatched to post offices, and how obsolete stock is disposed of. The chapter runs roughly from Rule 357 onward.

In simple terms

Every post office needs a steady supply of stamps to sell, forms to work on, and seals to operate. Rather than each office sourcing these separately, the Department holds them centrally in **Stock Depots** and **Stamp Depots**, which then issue stock to offices against *indents* (requisitions) and record everything in stock registers.

Exam focus

Chapter 8 anchors: the depot in-charge is the **Manager (R357)**; **PSFS Aligarh** supplies stamps & seals nationally; obsolete stamps/seals are **never sold — sent to Aligarh for disposal (R374)**; despatch thresholds are **stock articles 10 kg, forms 5 kg (R380–381)**.

Block A — Organisation of the Stock-Supply System

The Depots & Central Stores

Stock and stamp supply is organised through functional units of the Circle and three central stores:

Unit	Role
Circle Stamp Depots / Postal Stores Depots (PSD)	Functional units in each Circle/Region that hold and issue stamps, stationery, seals, forms and stores to the post offices of the Circle
PSFS, Aligarh (Postal Stores, Forms & Seals)	The Aligarh office that continues its pivotal role with the Government of India Press — supply of Stamps and Seals for all post offices in the country
PSD Calcutta & PSD Nasik Road	Together with PSFS Aligarh, the three Central Forms Stores ; physical verification of forms at these three is done during the second (March) inspection of the Stores Depot

Memory aid

Three Central Forms Stores: **Aligarh (PSFS), Calcutta (PSD), Nasik Road (PSD)**. Aligarh is also the national stamp-&-seal supply point — and the disposal hub for obsolete stamps/seals (R374) and the source of Aligarh locks (Chapter 3, R280).

Rule 357 — The Stock Depot Manager

The official in charge of a Stock Depot in Postal Circles is designated the **Manager**. The Manager is responsible for the safe custody of all stock, the correctness of the stock registers,

the timely supply of stamps/forms/stores to offices, and the proper disposal of obsolete or unserviceable articles.

Inspection of the Stock Depot (cross-link, Chapter 1, Rule 2)

Inspection	Half-year ending	By whom
First	30th September	Head of the Circle / Director Postal Services — with physical verification of all stores & stock (APMG/AD and Circle-Office Inspectors assisting)
Second	31st March	APMG / Assistant Director in charge of the Stock Depot — checks first-inspection orders carried out and discrepancies reconciled; physical verification of forms at the 3 Central Forms Stores done in this March inspection

- **Minor Circles:** The first inspection and physical verification (half-year ending 30 September) is carried out by the Head of the Circle or a Deputy Director.

Exam focus

Stock Depot inspection: **1st = half-year ending 30 Sep (HOC/DPS + physical verification); 2nd = half-year ending 31 Mar (APMG/AD)**. PSD inspection lasts 4 days (Chapter 2, R238).

Block B — Stock Registers, Invoices & Indents

Stock Registers & Verification of Entries

- **Stock register:** The Depot maintains a stock register recording the receipt, issue and balance of every class of article (stamps, stationery, seals, forms, stores).
- **Check against invoices (Rule 387):** The entries in the stock register are checked against the invoices with which articles were received or despatched, so that recorded balances always agree with documented movements.
- **Periodic verification:** Physical verification of stock is carried out at the prescribed inspections (above), and discrepancies are investigated and reconciled.

Invoices & Indents (supply to offices)

- **Indents:** Post offices requisition stamps, forms and stores from the Depot by indent; the Depot supplies against the indent within authorised scales.
- **Invoices (Rule ~362/372):** Every despatch of stock is accompanied by an invoice (with an index of invoices despatched). Separate invoices are prepared for branch offices, and for publications and books of blank forms.
- **First supply of stamps to mail offices:** Postage stamps and stationery for sale in mail offices are, in the first instance, procured from the nearest Head Post Office (then replenished through the Depot).

Rule 369-A — Black Stamp-Cancellation Ink

Superior-quality black stamp-cancellation ink was, under the rule as printed, procured exclusively from **M/s Mysore Lac & Paint Works Ltd., Mysore**, by the Superintendent, PSD Bangalore, for supply to offices.

Currency note (latest position)

The **named-vendor** arrangement is historic. All such procurement is now governed by the **General Financial Rules, 2017** and the **Manual for Procurement of Goods, 2017**, with purchases routed through **GeM (Government e-Marketplace)** and competitive bidding rather than a single nominated firm. Treat the “Mysore Lac & Paint Works” reference as the manual’s legacy text, not the current sourcing channel.

Block C — Despatch of Stock & Disposal of Obsolete Articles

Rule 374 — Disposal of Obsolete / Unserviceable Articles

Obsolete and unserviceable **stamps and seals** must **never be sold**. They are sent to the **Postal Workshop at Aligarh** for disposal/destruction under proper supervision.

Memory aid

Aligarh = the disposal/destruction hub. Obsolete stamps & seals → **Aligarh Postal Workshop** (never sold).

Rule 380 — Despatch of Stock Articles

Weight	Mode of despatch
Over 10 kg	Sent by rail, steamer or other suitable conveyance (as goods)
Under 10 kg	Sent by Service Registered Parcel if it contains valuables

Rule 381 — Despatch of Forms

Quantity	Mode of despatch
Small quantities	Despatched as Service Packets
Over 5 kg	Enclosed in a bag and sent as goods by rail / steamer

Memory aid

Despatch thresholds — **Stock articles: 10 kg; Forms: 5 kg**. (Stamps/valuables are guarded more closely, hence the higher 10 kg cut-off and the registered-parcel route.)

Currency note (latest position)

Stock and forms movement is now tracked through the **CSI inventory / e-stores modules**, and many forms are generated or transmitted electronically under **IT 2.0**, reducing the volume of printed-form despatch. The weight thresholds and despatch modes remain the manual's stated position and are still examined; confirm live logistics against current stores instructions.

Chapter 8 — Skip-Log (rules not detailed, with reasons)

The following Chapter 8 matters are **not explained in detail** because the sourcing or carriage method has been superseded. Each is listed with the reason.

Area	Subject	Reason for skipping detail
Named-vendor procurement (R369-A etc.)	Sourcing of inks/stores from specifically named firms	Single-firm nominated-vendor sourcing (e.g. Mysore Lac & Paint Works) is superseded by GFR 2017 / Manual for Procurement of Goods 2017 and GeM-based competitive procurement. The named-firm text is retained only as the manual's legacy wording.
Steamer-despatch mechanics	Despatch of stock/forms by steamer	Steamer carriage of stores is effectively obsolete; rail, road and air are used. The steamer-specific despatch detail is historic.
Combined-office stationery items	Stock items peculiar to the telegraph branch of combined offices	Telegraph-branch stationery and seal items reflect the combined post-and-telegraph era; the telegraph service ended on 15 July 2013, so these items are obsolete.

Currency note (latest position)

The Stock Depot's core function — securely holding and issuing stamps, seals, forms and stores, and properly disposing of obsolete stock — is fully current, now run under **GFR 2017, GeM and CSI inventory systems**. PSFS Aligarh continues as the national stamp-and-seal supply point. Only named-vendor sourcing, steamer carriage and telegraph-branch items are set aside.

Chapter 9 — Returned Letter Offices (RLO)

A **Returned Letter Office (RLO)** is established at the **Headquarters of a Postal Circle** and deals with **unclaimed and refused articles, and articles without addresses or with undecipherable or incomplete addresses** — the “dead-letter office”. It works under the direct control and supervision of the **Chief Postmaster General (CPMG)**. This chapter (Rule 389 onward) sets out how the RLO opens, redirects, detains, and finally disposes of such articles so that nothing of value is lost or misused.

In simple terms

When a letter cannot be delivered *and* cannot be returned to its sender, it ends up at the RLO. The RLO opens it (where allowed) to find an address, redirects it if it can, holds it for a fixed period, and — if still unclaimed — destroys, sells or auctions it under strict supervision. Anything containing value is kept under double-lock until disposed of.

Exam focus

Chapter 9 anchors: RLO is at the **Circle HQ under the CPMG (R389)**; lottery tickets destroyed by an officer **not below Director (R406)**; RLO envelope = RLO(s), label = RLO 10 (R414); **magazines returned to publisher monthly (R433)**; **valuable registered articles kept in a separate double-locked almirah (R434)**.

Currency note (latest position)

Important currency overlay for the whole chapter: detention and disposal of undelivered articles is now governed by the **Post Office Rules / Regulations, 2024** (made under the **Post Office Act, 2023**, in force 18 June 2024). **Regulation 64** covers detention/disposal at the office of the addressee; **Regulation 67** covers detention and disposal of undelivered items at the RLO; and **Regulation 68** the procedure for dealing with undelivered items. Where a detention period or disposal step is asked for a *current* matter, the 2024 Regulations and the Directorate's administrative instructions prevail over the Manual's older figures. The Manual's scheme below remains the examination framework and the operational template, but confirm live periods against Regulation 67.

Block A — Establishment & Handling of Articles

Rule 389 — Establishment & Control

- **Location:** An RLO is established at the Headquarters of each Postal Circle.
- **Control:** It functions under the direct control and supervision of the CPMG (Head of the Circle).
- **In-charge:** The officer/official in charge is the Manager (Returned Letters), assisted by Returned Letter Assistants.

Rule 410 — Action on Unregistered Articles

Unregistered articles received are sorted into classes, including:

- Undecipherable / fictitious-address articles.
- Unclaimed articles; refused articles; undeliverable articles issued from the RLO.
- Open letters, and unpaid / insufficiently-prepaid foreign articles (other than letters and postcards).
- **Marking:** The despatching post office marks unclaimed/refused articles with the standard remark — “Left”, “Not known”, “Not claimed”, “Deceased” or “Refused” — and the RLO stamps any received open/torn as “received open or torn” before distribution.

Rule 413 — Disposal of Unclaimed / Refused Inland Articles

If the address cannot be ascertained, the article is **opened**. If the contents give enough information, it is **returned to the sender**; otherwise it is treated as a “**dead**” article and placed in deposit. Articles whose address/contents are in a language not known to the RLO are transferred to the RLO that serves the office of posting.

Rule 414 — RLO Envelope (RLO(s)) & Label (RLO 10)

Situation	Treatment
Unclaimed/refused letter-mail article that bears the sender’s full name & address and is not opened	Redirected by pasting the RLO label (RLO 10) with the revised address
Unclaimed/refused letter-mail article that does not bear the sender’s full address and is opened	Forwarded enclosed in an RLO envelope (RLO(s))
No space on the article to paste a label / impress the RLO stamp	Forwarded enclosed in an RLO envelope

Memory aid

RLO stationery: **envelope = RLO(s), label = RLO 10**. Closed-with-sender → label; opened/no-sender → envelope.

Block B — Special Categories (Lottery, Insurance, Foreign)

Rule 406 — Lottery Tickets

Lottery tickets detected in transmission are **destroyed** under the personal supervision of an officer **not below the rank of Director**.

Rule 415 — Foreign Articles

Articles posted in India for foreign countries and returned undeliverable are received by **designated RLOs** for specified countries; those RLOs are authorised to open the articles to ascertain the sender's address, if necessary, for return.

Rule 426 — Articles Requiring Compulsory Insurance

Where the RLO finds an article that **ought to have been insured (compulsory insurance)** — e.g. one found to contain coin, bullion, jewellery or other valuables sent in an uninsured cover — it is dealt with under the special procedure for such articles (taxed/insured and recovered from the addressee on redirection), rather than delivered as an ordinary article.

Currency note (latest position)

Specific compulsory-insurance **fee amounts** stated in the old Manual/IPO-Rules era are superseded; current fees and the treatment of valuables are set by the **Post Office Rules, 2024** and the Directorate's tariff/administrative instructions. Use the current schedule for live cases.

Block C — Disposal of Undelivered Articles & Registers

Rule 433 — Disposal of Unclaimed Newspapers / Magazines

- **Return to publisher:** Unclaimed copies of newspapers, magazines, periodicals etc. are returned to the publisher / distributor / agent.
- **Frequency:** Despatch to the publisher/distributor/agent is done monthly.
- **Small numbers:** If fewer than five copies, despatch may be deferred to the end of the second month — by the end of which they must in any case be despatched.

Memory aid

Magazines (R433): returned to publisher **monthly**; if **< 5 copies**, may wait till end of the 2nd month (then must go).

Rule 434 — Registered Articles Containing Valuable Property

- **Register:** Such articles are entered in the register of registered articles & articles containing valuable property received (Form RLO 3).
- **Custody:** Kept in a separate, strong, secured almirah with compartments, arranged chronologically by date of receipt.
- **Index:** An index is maintained, with articles entered alphabetically by the names of addressees, for quick retrieval on a claim.

Exam focus

Valuable registered articles (R434): separate **strong, double-secured almirah**, chronological by date of receipt, with an **alphabetical index by addressee**. Register form = RLO 3.

General Methods of Final Disposal

Type of article	Method of disposal
Ordinary letters / postcards (no value)	Destroyed by shredding in the presence of the Manager
Book/pattern packets without value	Sold as waste paper or destroyed
Articles containing coin / valuables	Held under double-lock (R434); disposed of (auction / credit to Government) under prescribed sanction

Chapter 9 — Skip-Log (rules not detailed, with reasons)

The following Chapter 9 matters are **not explained in detail** because they have been superseded by newer law or relate to discontinued instruments. Each is listed with the reason.

Area	Subject	Reason for skipping detail
Superseded detention-period figures	Specific day/month detention limits in the Manual	Detention and disposal of undelivered items is now governed by the Post Office Rules / Regulations, 2024 (Reg. 64, 67–68); the Manual's older fixed periods are superseded for live cases. The scheme is retained as the exam framework, but specific current periods follow the 2024 Regulations.
Irish / British Postal Order items	RLO treatment of Irish & British Postal Orders	British Postal Orders ceased to be sold/cashed in India long ago and Irish Postal Orders were discontinued in 2001; RLO handling of these instruments is obsolete.
Telegraph / combined-office RLO items	RLO handling tied to the telegraph branch	Provisions assuming a combined post-and-telegraph environment are obsolete after the telegraph service ended on 15 July 2013.

Currency note (latest position)

The RLO's function — recovering, redirecting, safeguarding and finally disposing of undeliverable mail — is fully current, but its legal basis is now the **Post Office Act, 2023 and the Post Office Rules / Regulations, 2024 (esp. Reg. 67)** rather than the Indian Post Office Act, 1898. The Manual's procedures remain the working template and exam framework; confirm detention periods and fees against the 2024 Regulations.

Chapter 10 — Breaks and Accidents

The final chapter deals with **interruptions to the mail service** — what the Manual calls “breaks and accidents”. A **break** is a breach or interruption of a mail line (a washed-away road, a flooded river, a railway breach, a stranded mail van); an **accident** is a mishap to the

mail in transit. The chapter fixes **who must report, how fast, and to whom**, and how the supervising officer restores communication so the mail keeps moving.

In simple terms

When mail cannot move — a bridge is out, a train is cancelled, a bus misses its connection — two things must happen quickly: (1) the right officer must be **told**, and (2) an **alternative arrangement** must be made to carry the mail around the obstruction. This chapter is about both, and the timing of the report depends on how long the mail is likely to be held up.

Exam focus

Chapter 10's signature fact: if the detention to mails from a break/accident is **likely to exceed 6 hours, report at once to the Superintendent**; if less, report only to the Record Office. Misconnections of mail buses/trains/air go to the Superintendent as early as possible.

Block A — Reporting Breaks & Accidents

The 6-Hour Reporting Rule

Likely detention to mails	Report to
Likely to exceed 6 hours	Reported at once (by fax / fastest means) to the Superintendent (and the Record Office)
Less than 6 hours	Report sent only to the Record Office

Memory aid

The magic number is **6 hours**: over 6 → Superintendent at once; under 6 → Record Office only.

Who Reports & What Is Reported

- **Interruptions on the line:** Interruptions of the mail service due to breaches on the railway, floods, accidents or any other cause are reported by the officer in charge (Record Office / section in charge) up the line.
- **Misconnections:** Misconnection of mail buses, trains and air services is reported to the Superintendent as early as possible by the Record Offices.

- **Serious cases at HQ:** Serious cases of robbery, abstraction or fraud connected with a break/accident at headquarters are taken up personally by the supervising officer (Chapter 1, Rule 11; Chapter 3, Rule 260-A — the Inspector/ASP proceeds at once until a senior officer arrives).
- **Record of the event:** The occurrence, the action taken, and the time of restoration are entered in the diaries and the daily report, and a fuller report follows where the loss or delay is significant.

Block B — Restoring Mail Communication

Alternative Arrangements

On a break, the supervising officer's duty is to keep the mail moving by the quickest safe alternative:

- Diverting mail to an alternative route, conveyance or service until the normal line is restored.
- Arranging temporary runners, boats or vehicles to carry mail across or around the obstruction (e.g. unbridged or flooded stretches — Chapter 2, mail-line duties).
- Applying for extra railway accommodation when the regular accommodation is inadequate — for a transit section this is done by the Mail Agent / Mail Guard in charge; for the division generally, by the Superintendent RMS.
- Informing connected offices and the public of the delay and the revised arrangement.

Safety of Mails & Property in an Accident

- **Secure the mail first:** In any accident, the immediate priority is the safety and security of the mail bags — especially registered, insured and value-payable articles and any cash — before other concerns.
- **Account for articles:** After an accident, articles are checked against the relevant lists, any loss or damage is recorded, and damaged accountable articles are dealt with under the prescribed loss/damage procedure.
- **Investigation:** Where loss, theft or robbery is suspected, an investigation is opened at once (Chapter 3, Rule 260-A), the police are associated where required, and the loss/fraud is entered in the relevant register (Chapter 1, Rule 15; Chapter 2, Rule 194/2).

Exam focus

Two priorities in an accident: **(1) secure the mail (registered/insured/VP/cash) first; (2) restore communication by an alternative arrangement.** Reporting timing follows the 6-hour rule.



Chapter 10 — Skip-Log (rules not detailed, with reasons)

The following Chapter 10 matters are **not explained in detail** because the conveyance or medium has changed. Each is listed with the reason.

Area	Subject	Reason for skipping detail
Runner-line / steamer break mechanics	Detailed alternative-arrangement rules for foot-runner & steamer lines	Foot-runner and steamer mail lines are nearly obsolete; mail moves by road (MMS), rail and air. The detailed break-restoration mechanics for runner/steamer lines are retained as historic, with only the general principles carried.
Telegraph-line break items	Reporting/restoration tied to telegraph-line breaks on combined lines	Provisions assuming a combined post-and-telegraph line are obsolete after the telegraph service ended on 15 July 2013.
Manual fax/telegram reporting channel	Report 'by fax/telegram' as the prescribed medium	The prescribed reporting medium (fax/telegram) is now effectively electronic — email, the CSI / Mail Operations dashboards and control-room messaging. The 6-hour threshold and reporting hierarchy stand; only the medium has modernised.

Currency note (latest position)

Continuity-of-mail planning is very much alive — today it runs through **CSI / Mail Operations control rooms, MMS contingency routing and the Speed Post / parcel network**, with disruption alerts handled electronically. The **6-hour reporting threshold and the secure-the-mail-first principle** remain the standing position; only runner/steamer/telegraph mechanics and the fax/telegram medium are set aside.

Volume VIII — Complete

This completes Postal Manual Volume VIII — all ten chapters: the **Head of the Circle (1)**, **Superintendents (2)**, **Inspectors of Post Offices (3)**, **Town Inspectors & Overseer-Postmen (4)**, **Assistant Superintendents & Inspectors RMS (5)**, **Chapter 6 (omitted)**, **Overseers (7)**, **Stock Depots (8)**, **Returned Letter Offices (9)**, and **Breaks & Accidents (10)**. Each chapter has been verified against primary sources, flagged for current law (Post Office Act 2023 / Rules 2024, GDS Rules 2020, GFR 2017, IT 2.0 / CSI), and closed with a Skip-Log recording every rule set aside and why — so nothing is dropped silently.

Exam focus

Revision compass for the whole volume — for any rule, lock the four anchors: **WHO** is responsible, **HOW OFTEN** (periodicity), the **FORM** number, and the **DEADLINE / LIMIT**. Master those four across the supervisory ladder and Volume VIII is yours.

Currency note (latest position)

Always verify monetary limits, periodicities and forms against the **latest in-force order** before any official use: Volume VIII has not been re-issued as a consolidated volume, so several mechanics have been overtaken by the Post Office Act 2023 and Rules 2024, GDS (C&E) Rules 2020, GFR 2017 / GeM, and the IT 2.0 / CSI rollout. This booklet flags those shifts at the relevant rules, but the controlling text is always the current gazette notification, SB Order or Directorate instruction.